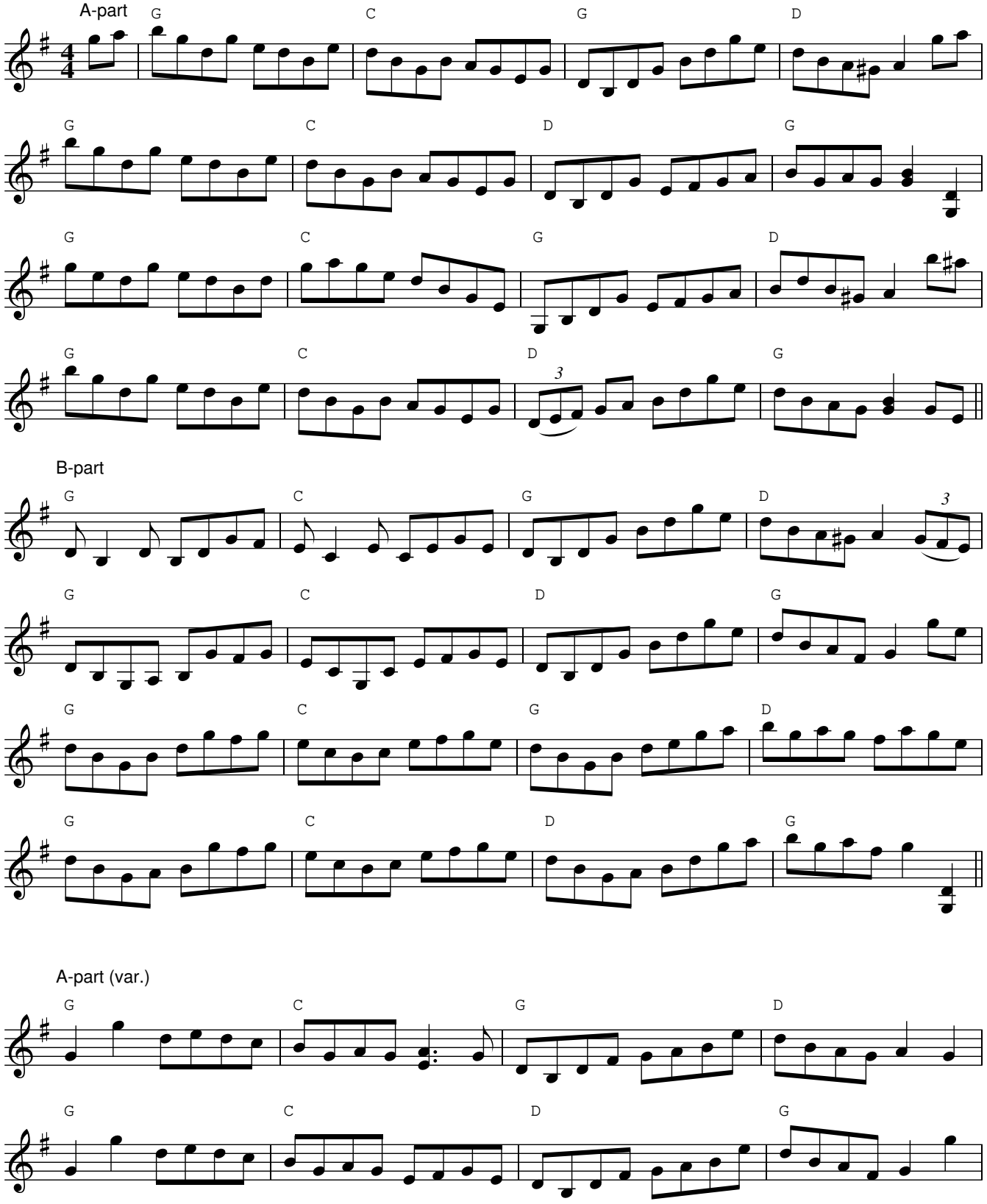
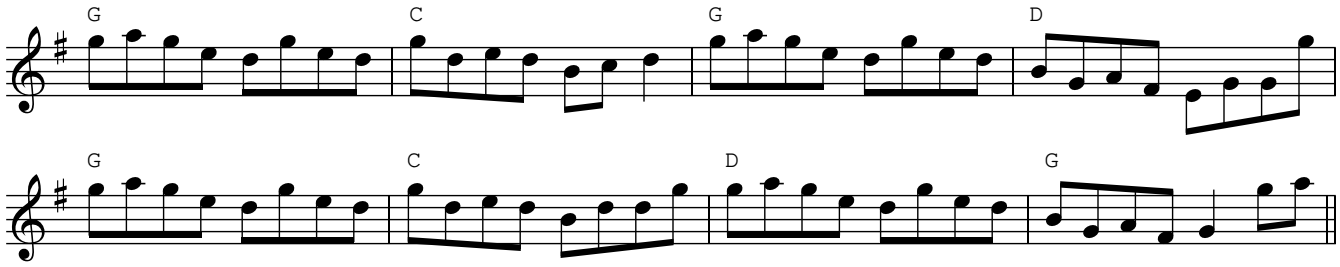
Bitter Creek

Trad.
reel



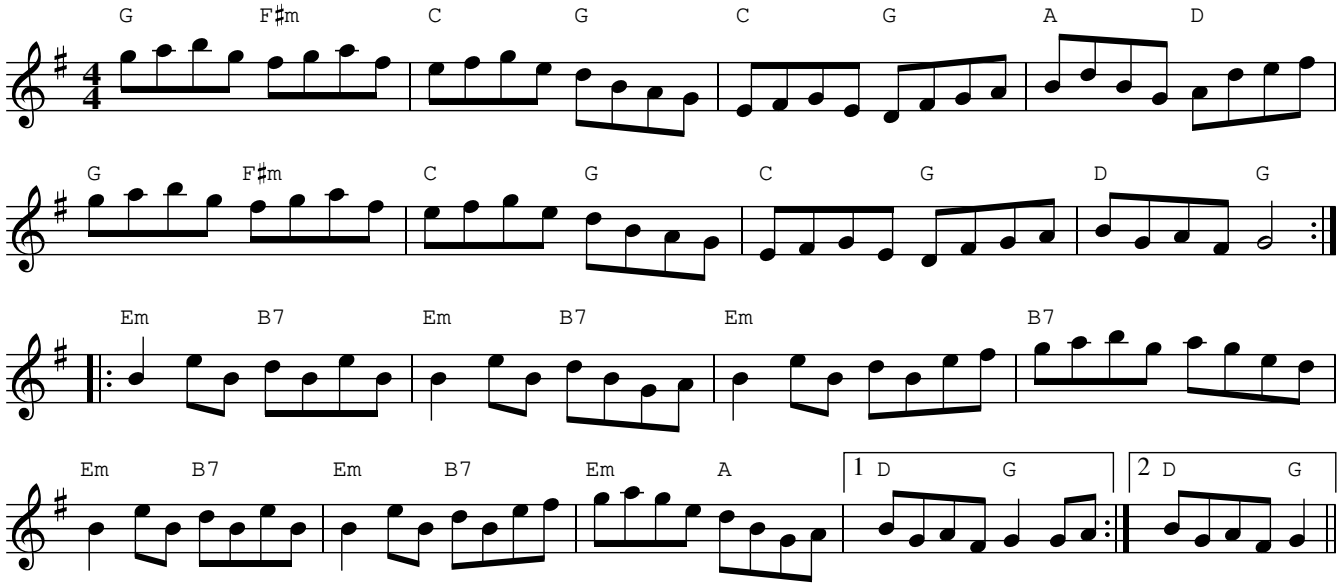


Chords: G C G D | G C D G :|

Source: A-part var. by Oscar Harper at https://tunearch.org/wiki/Bitter_Creek.

Blackberry Blossom

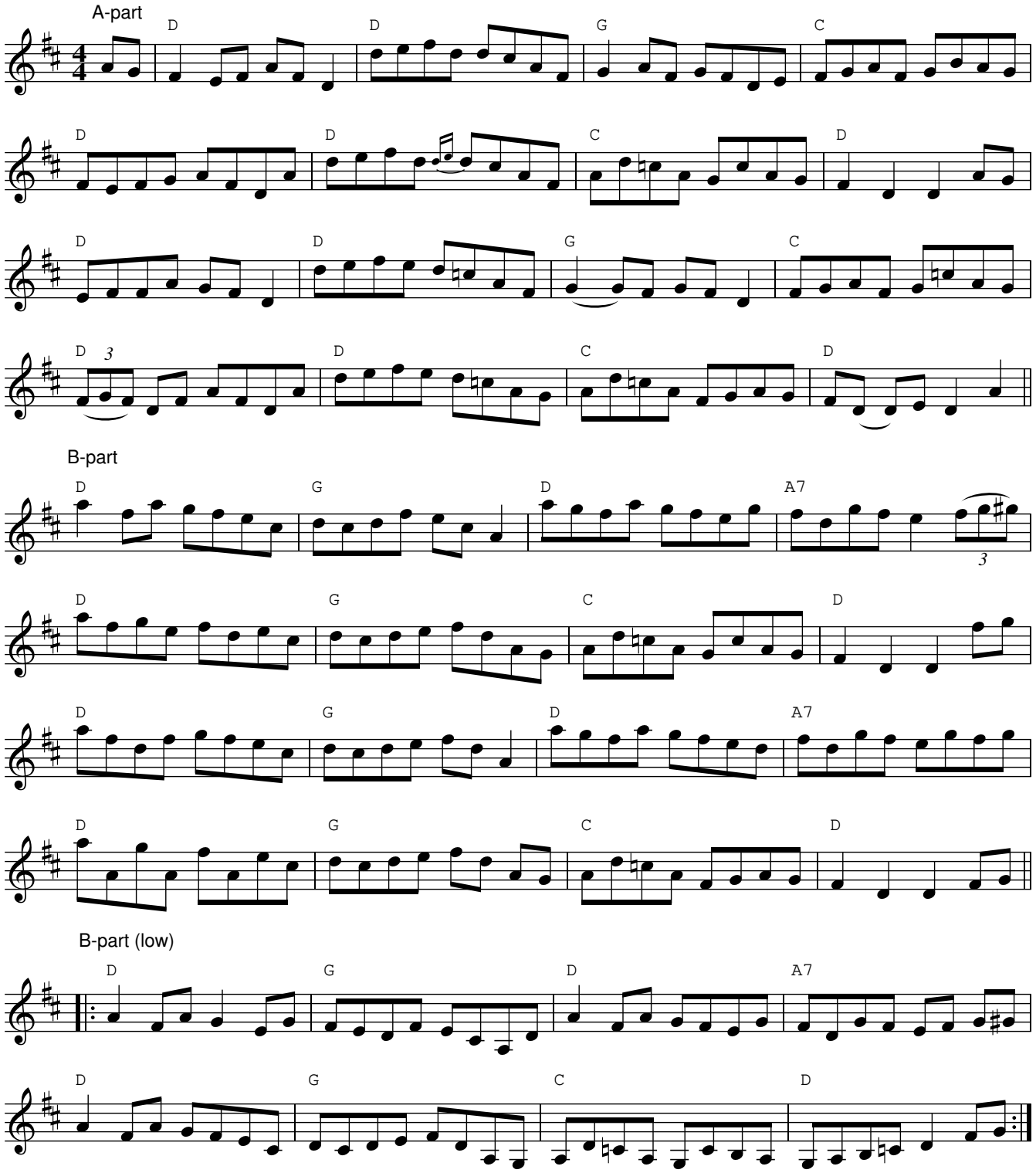
Trad.
reel



Chords: G/F#m C/G C/G A/D | G/F#m C/G C/G D/G :| Em/B7 Em/B7 Em B7 | Em/B7 Em/B7 Em/A D/G :|

Blackbird Hornpipe (1)

Trad.
hornpipe



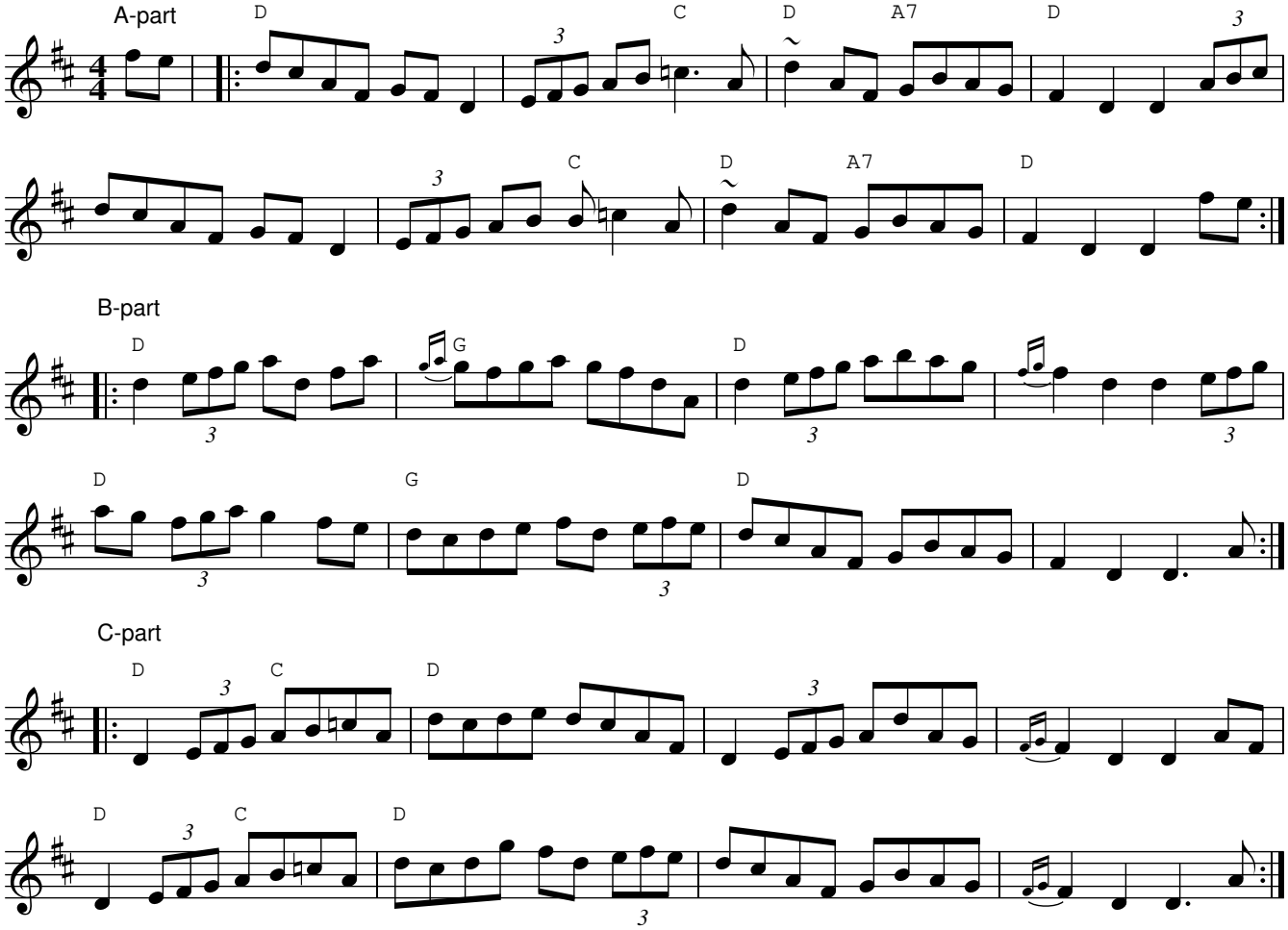
Chords: D D G C | D D C D :| D G D A7 | D G C D :|

Source: Amanda Kerr; Randal Bays + Dave Marshall (with my own licks added)

Notes: Another new tune for me. Seems to have a lot in common with The Blackbird set dance, with its repeated landing on the open D, but is also recognizably distinct. Still figuring out chords and fine-tuning the arrangement. One interesting feature is a "slippery" C, sometimes sharp in line with with the key signature and sometimes dropping down to natural.

Blackbird Hornpipe (2)

Trad.
hornpipe



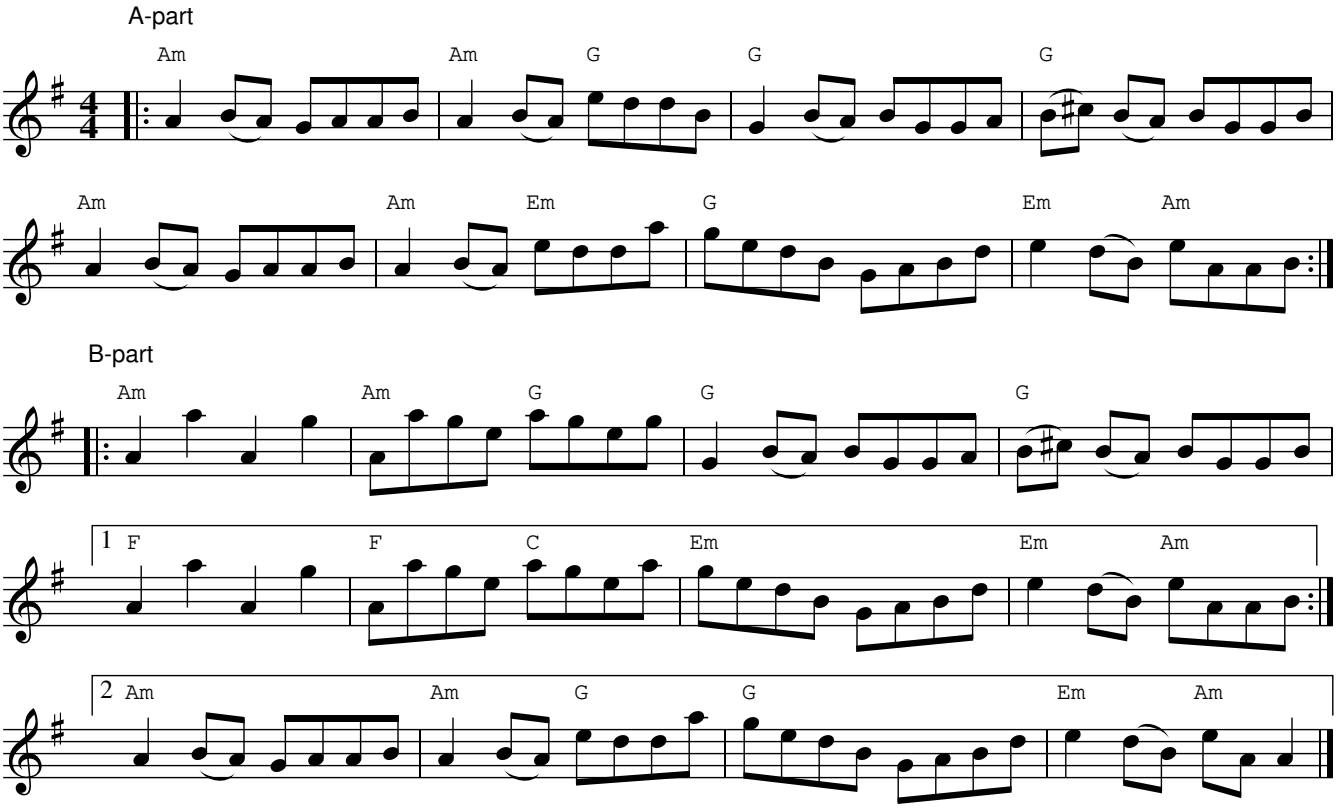
Source: Padraig McGovern and Peter Carberry: https://youtu.be/5vidJn-Ebyc?si=eCc98qBibmGQ52gS

Notes: This is another version of the Blackbird Hornpipe, clearly related to the previous one.
A little more repetitive, but in a good way! Good as a reference.
Chording remains basic / uncertain.

Brenda Stubbert's Reel

a.k.a. Frosty Morning

Jerry Holland
reel



A-part: Am Am/G G G | Am Am/Em G Em/A :|

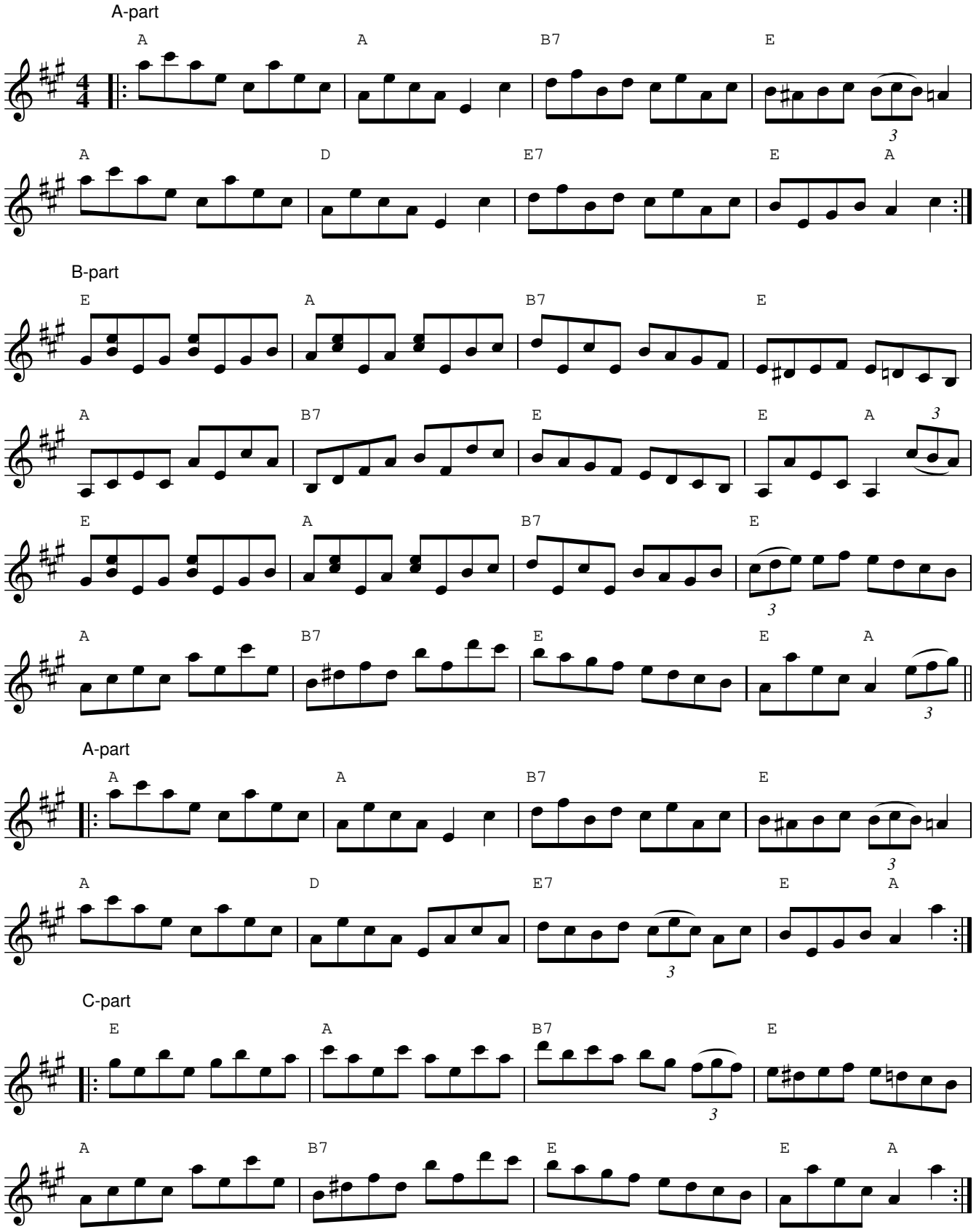
B-part: Am Am G G | F F/C Em Em/A | <repeat A-part once>

Source: Ashley MacIssac, _Hi(tm) How Are You Today?_ (1995)

Notes: Ashley plays it in Bb, but the standard key is A Dorian. I like his accidentals.

Butterfly Hornpipe

Trad.
hornpipe

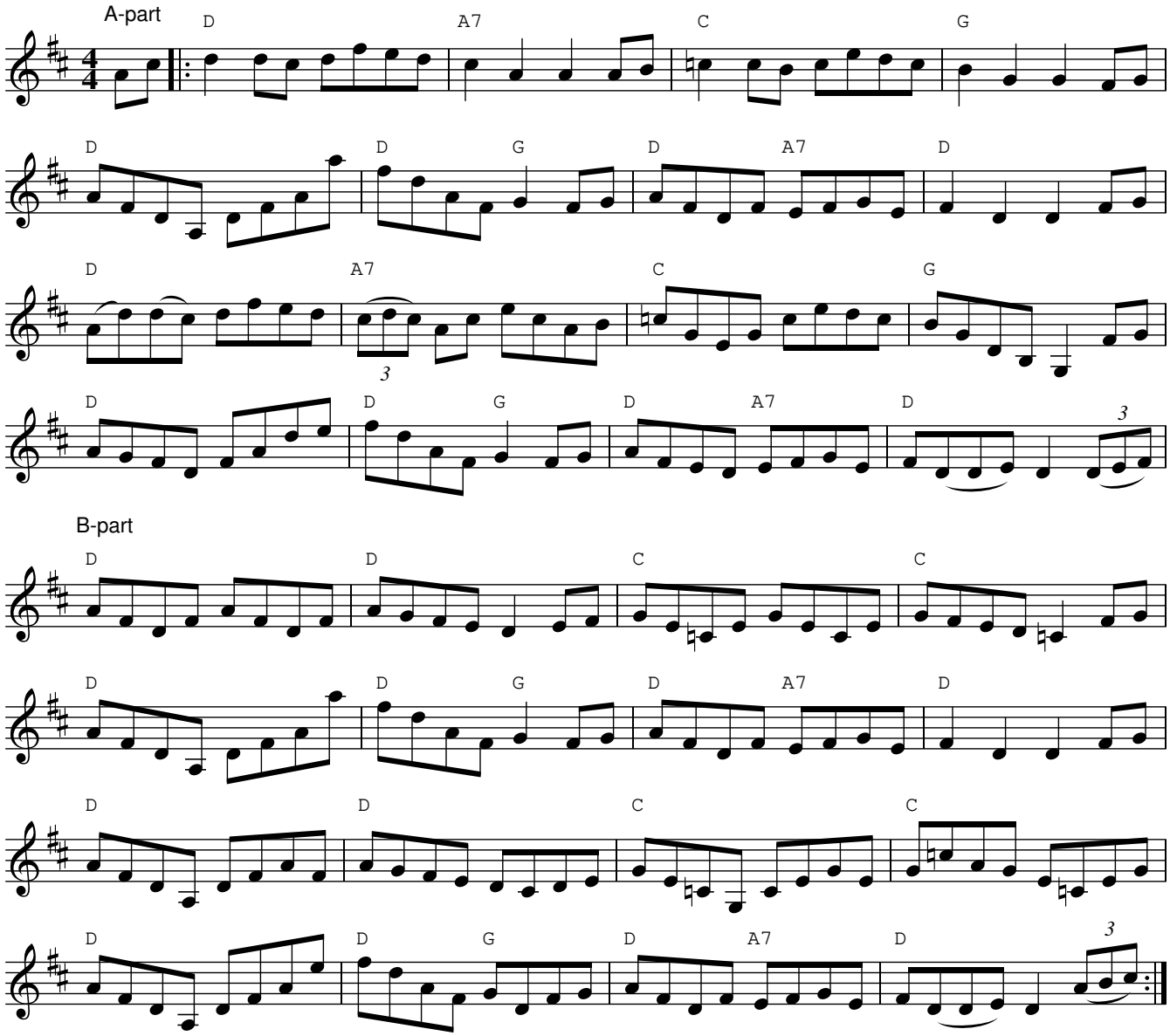


Chords: A A B7 E | A D E7 E/A :| E A B7 E | A B7 E E/A :|

Source: Terry Morris, _For the Record_ and other jam recordings.
Notes: For all his improvisational abilities, Terry is remarkably consistent with this tune.
I guess he liked it this way! :)

Cuckoo's Nest

Trad.
reel



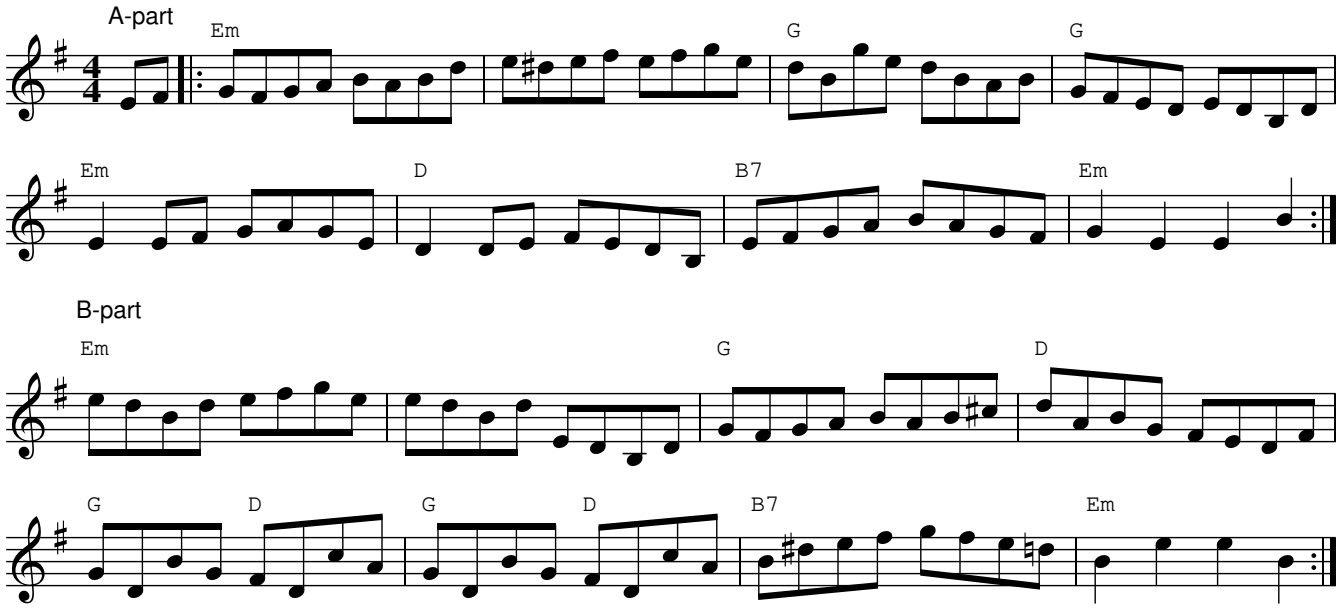
Chords: D A7 C G | D D/G D/A7 D :| D D C C | D D/G D/A7 D :|

Notes: Interestingly, _The Fiddler's Bible_ reverses the order of parts.

The Democratic Hornpipe

a.k.a. Galway Bay

Trad.
hornpipe



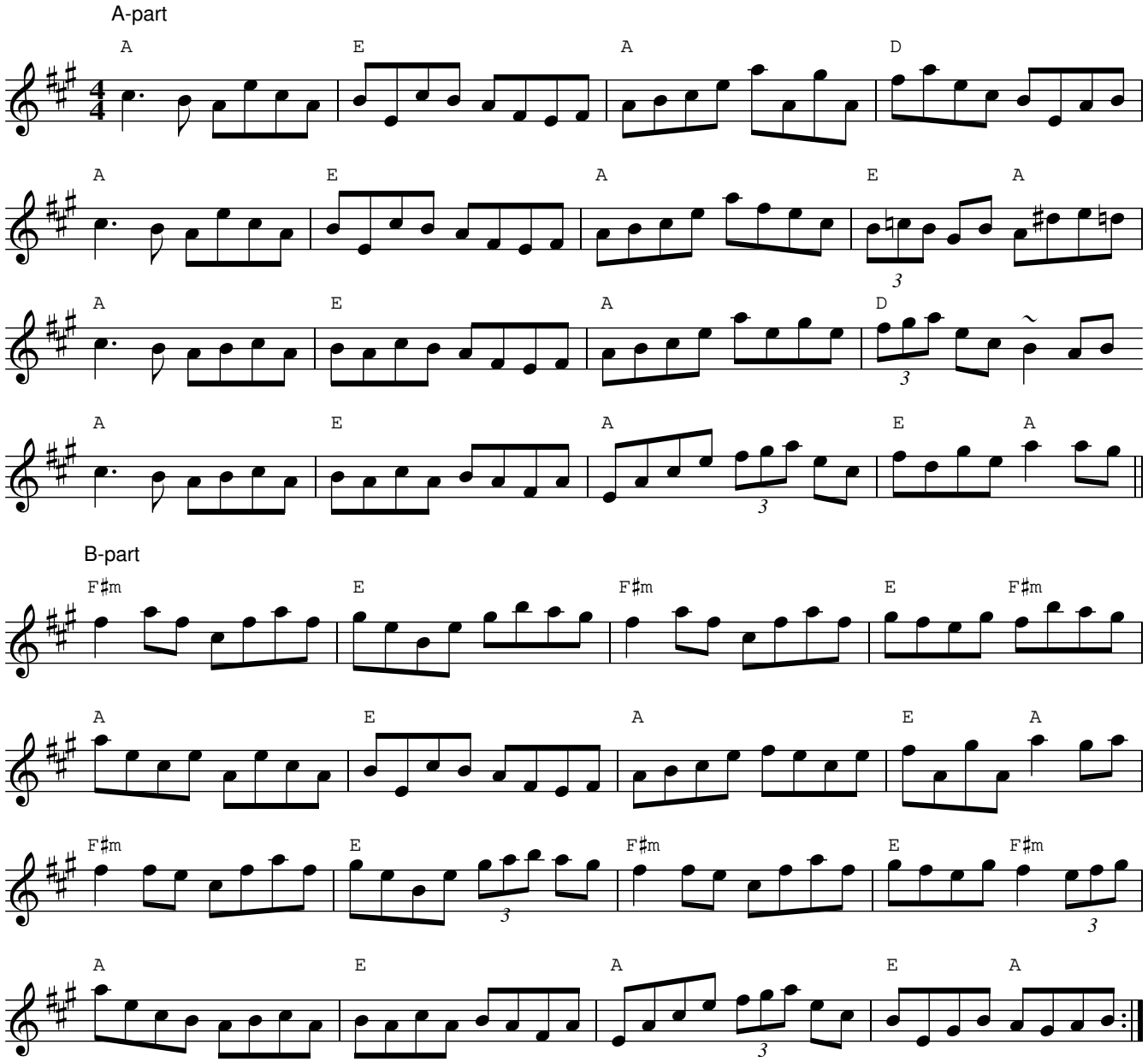
Chords: Em Em G G | Em D B7 Em :| Em Em G D | G/D G/D B7 Em :|

Source: _The Fiddler's Bible_ (transposed to Em)

Notes: A really interesting tune with a lot of movement. Also frequently played in Gm, but I don't want the guitarists to murder me. Chording is still tentative.

The Derry Reel

Eugene O'Donnell?
reel

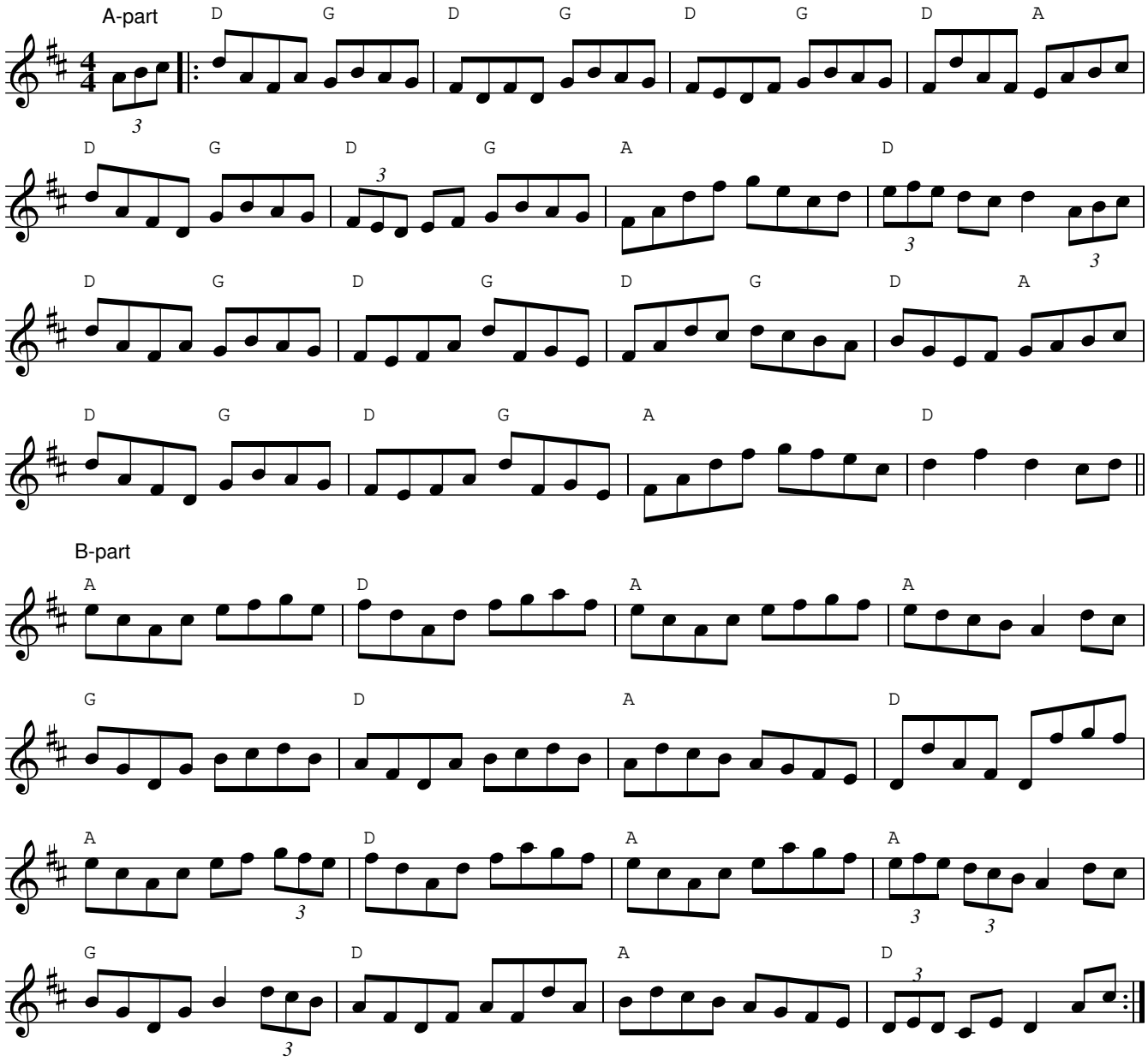


Chords: A E A D | A E A E/A :| F#m E F#m E/F#m | A E A E/A :|

Notes: Cobbled from two versions found at thesession.org/tunes/7671. I really like the B-part!

Fisher's Hornpipe (D)

Trad.
hornpipe

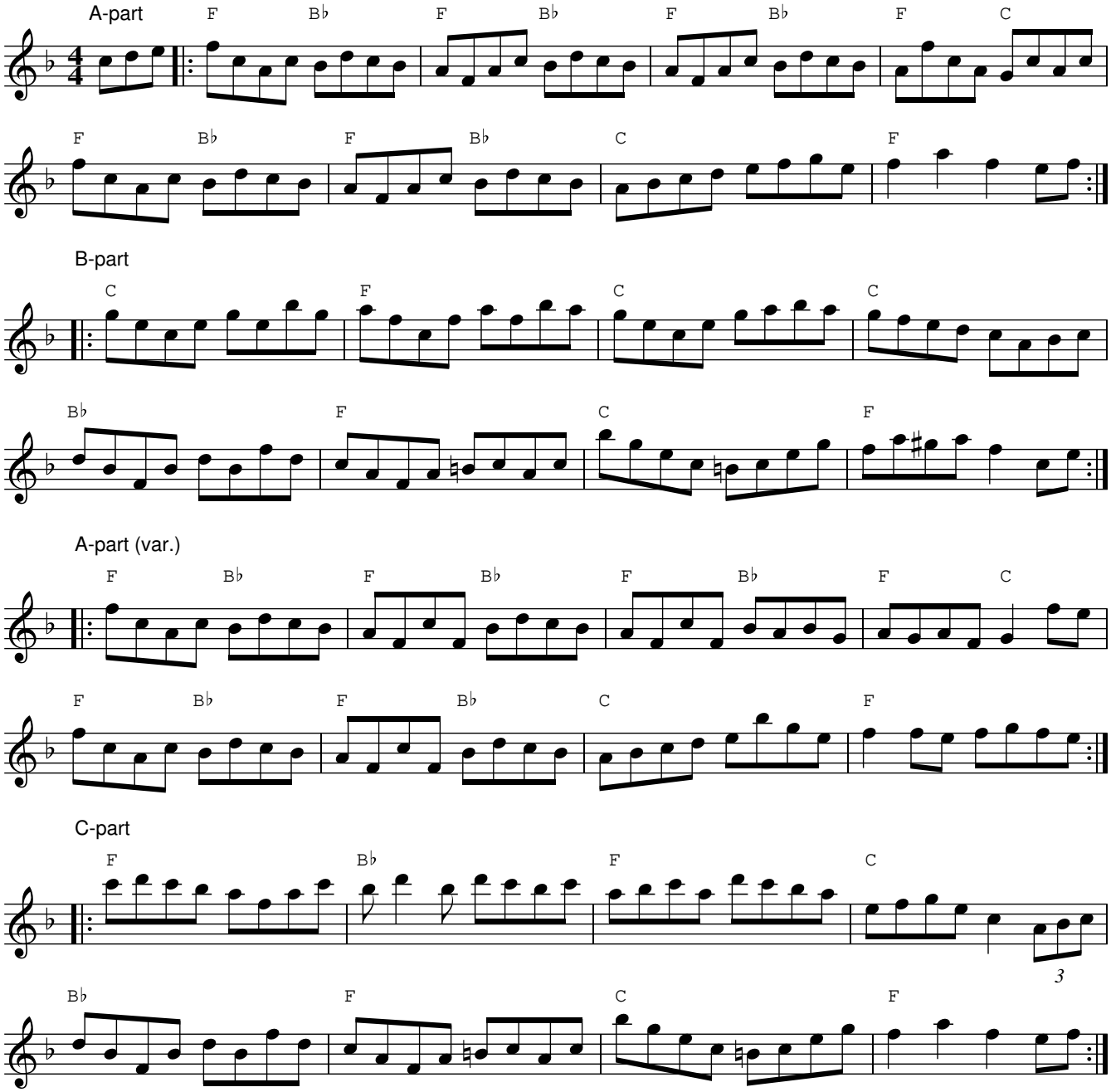


Chords: D/G D/G D/G D/A | D/G D/G A D :| A D A A | G D A D :|

Notes: This is commonly played in either D or F major. Here are some examples of it in D, sourced and adapted from various transcriptions at https://thesession.org/tunes/872.

Fisher's Hornpipe (F)

Trad.
hornpipe

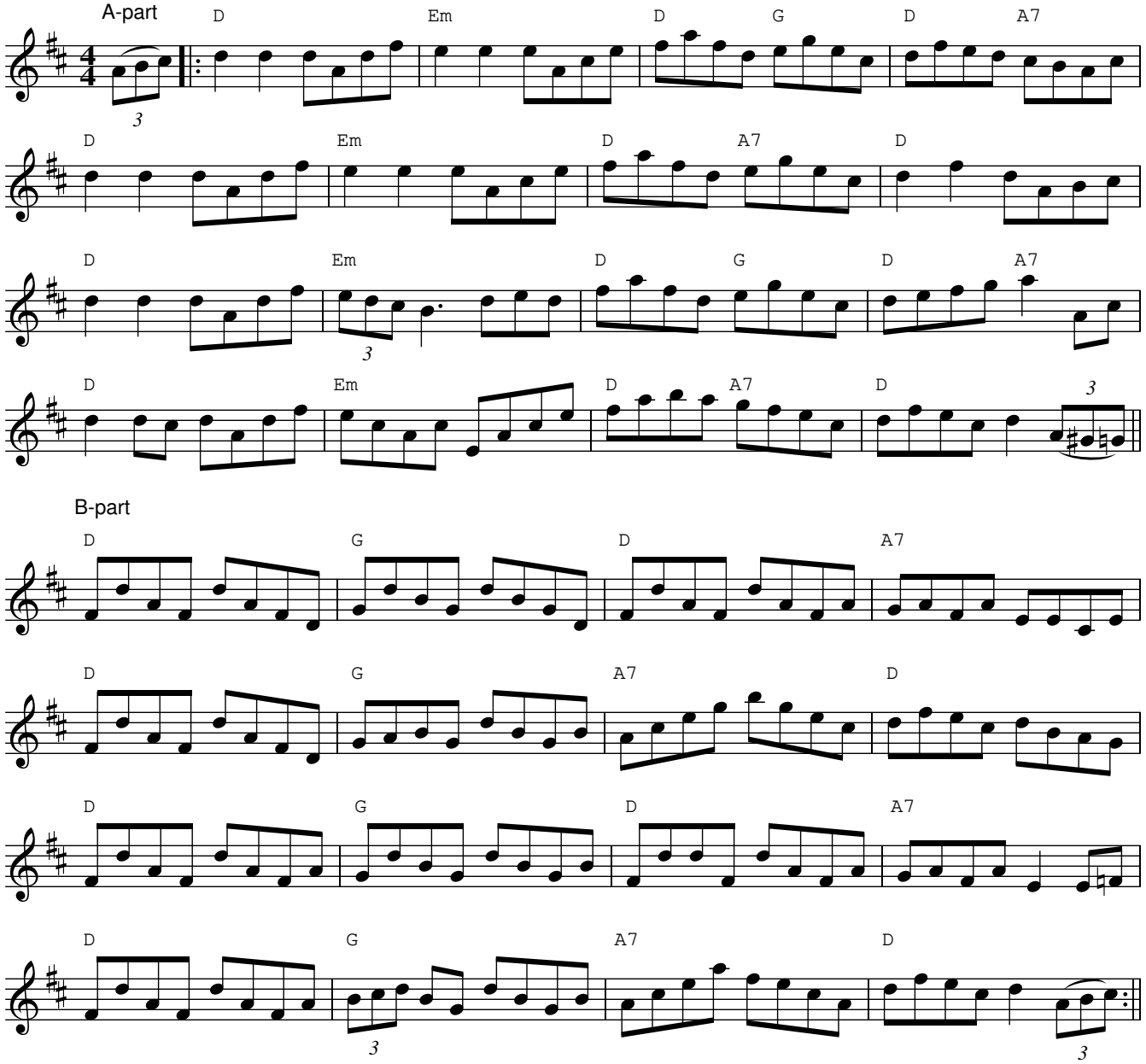


Chords: F/Bb F/Bb F/Bb F/C | F/Bb F/Bb C F :| C F C C | Bb F C F :| F Bb F C | Bb F C F :|

Notes: Here's the F version as I learned it, along with a nice variation on the A-part
I found at https://thesession.org/tunes/872.

Gin Rickshaw

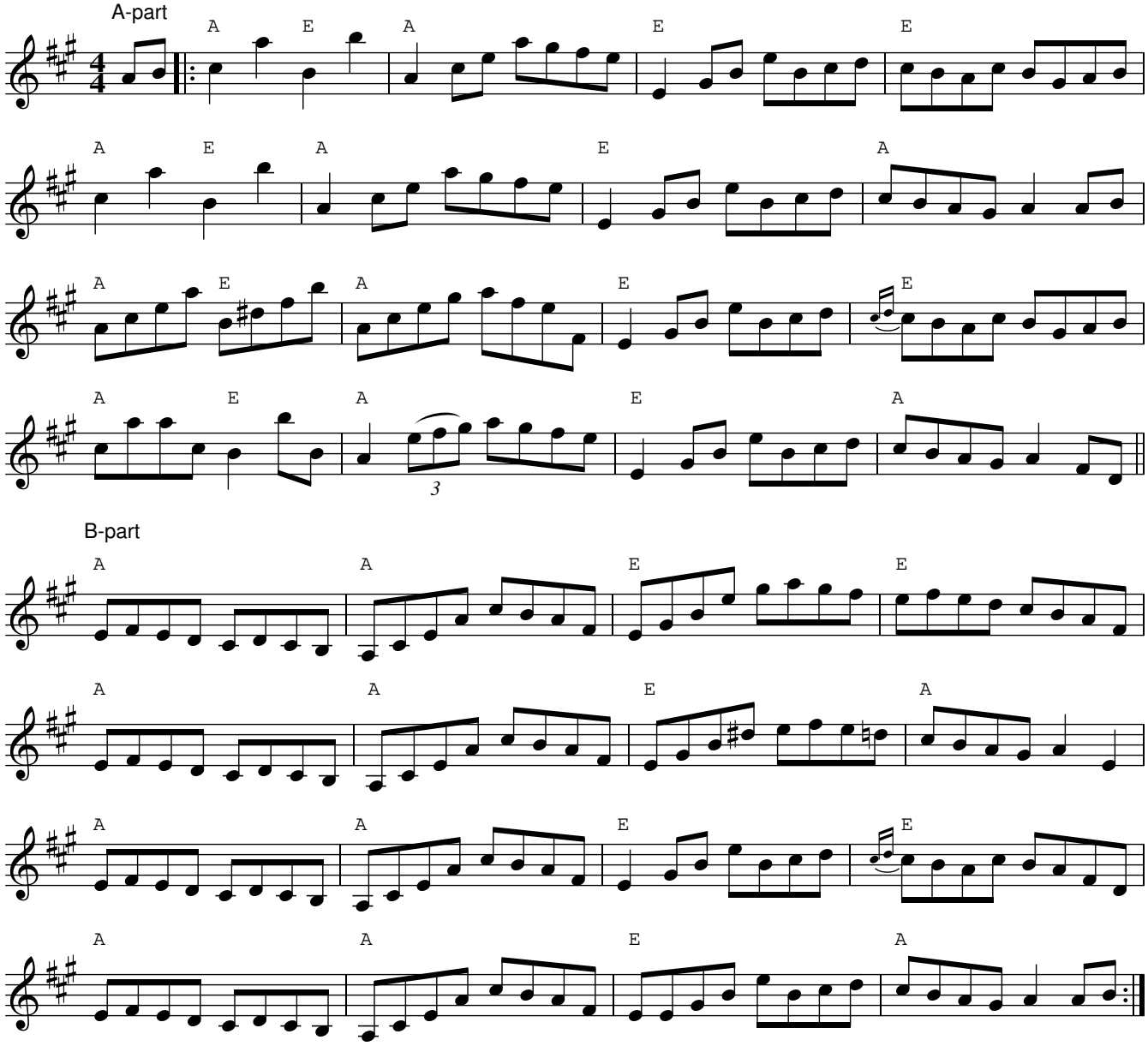
Trad.
reel



Chords: D Em D/G D/A | D Em D/G A/D :| D G D A7 | D G A7 D :|

Hummingbird Reel

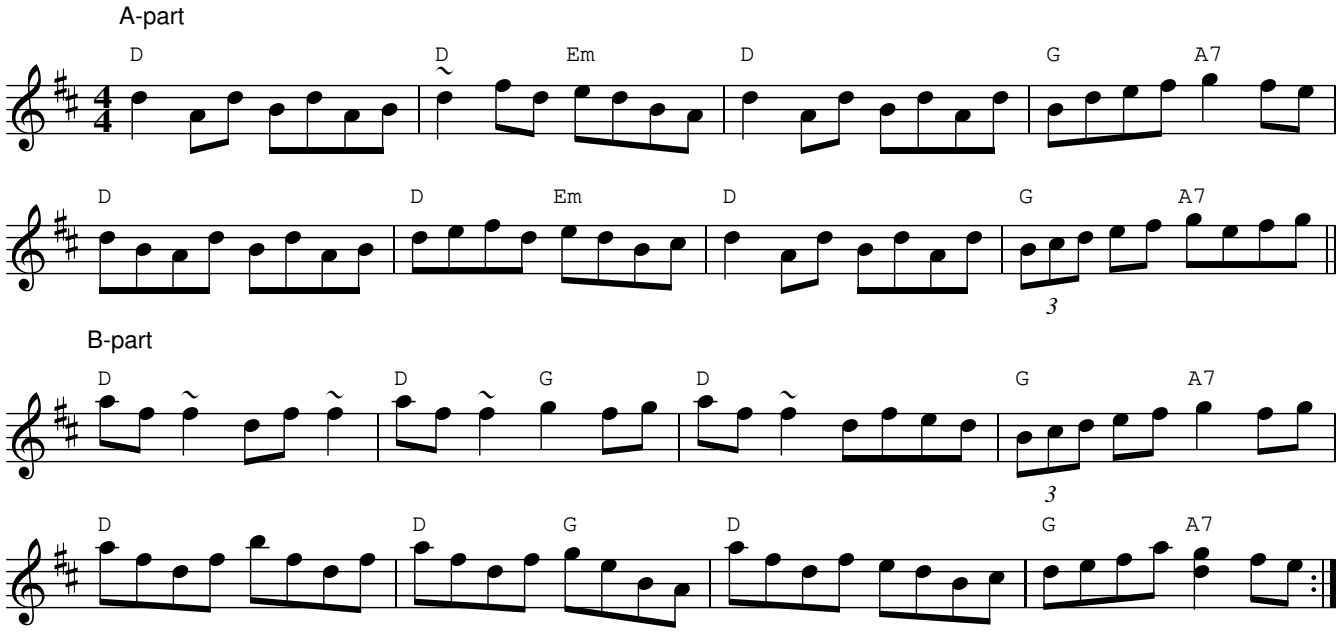
Trad.
reel



Chords: A/E A E E | A/E A E A :| A A E E | A A E A :|

The Humours of Tulla

Trad.
reel



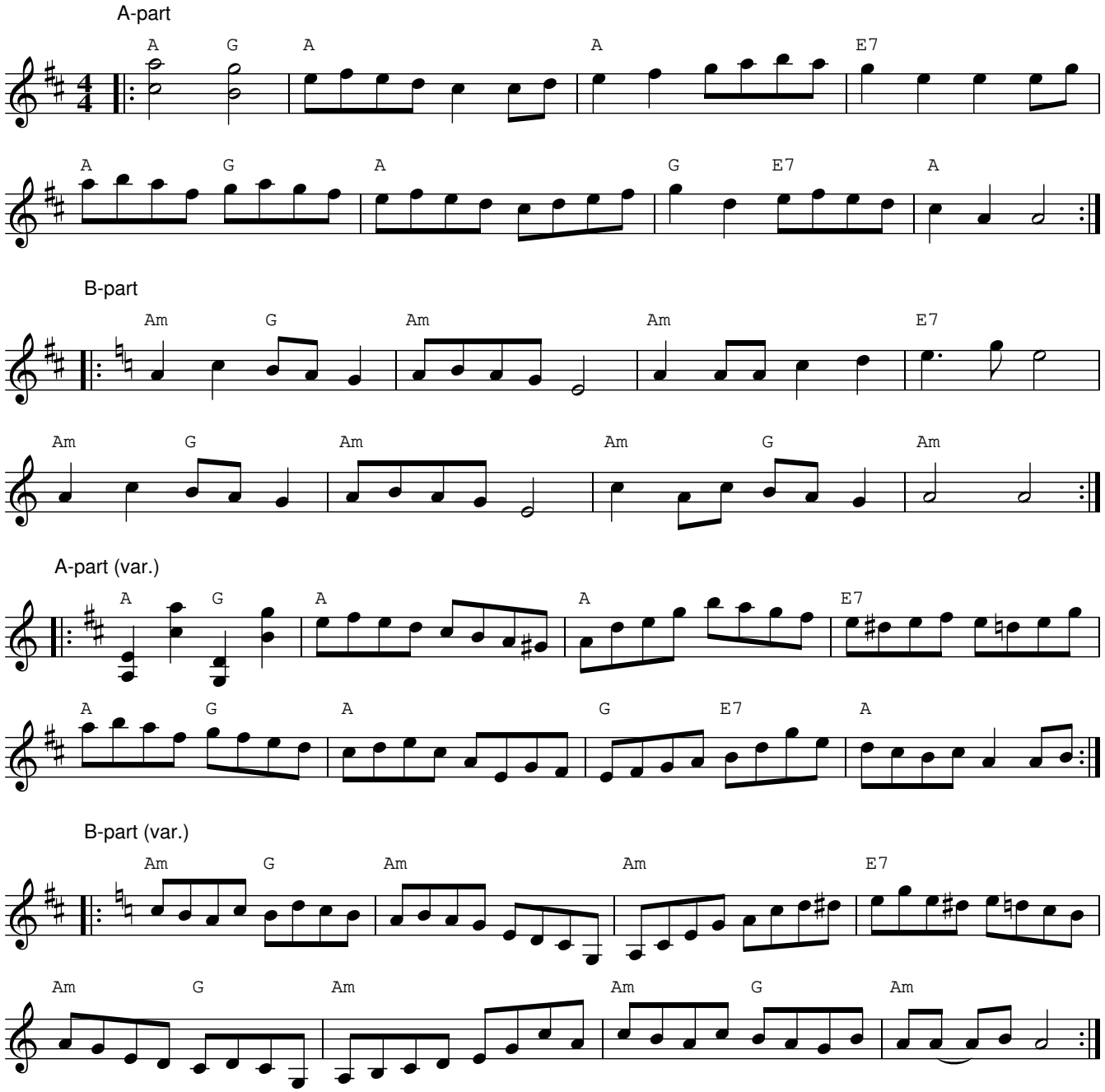
Chords: D D/Em D G/A7 :| D D/G D G/A7 :|

Source: Adapted from versions at https://thesession.org/tunes/141

Notes: A fun tune I was shown in Durham! First comes the basic melody, then my variations. The G and Em chords are fairly interchangeable. I mix and match them in this arrangement. The ~ signs mark Irish rolls, meaning you need to do something like bow triplets to make it more interesting. Or fiddle through it, like I have in the second half of the B-part.

The Kitchen Girl

Trad.
reel



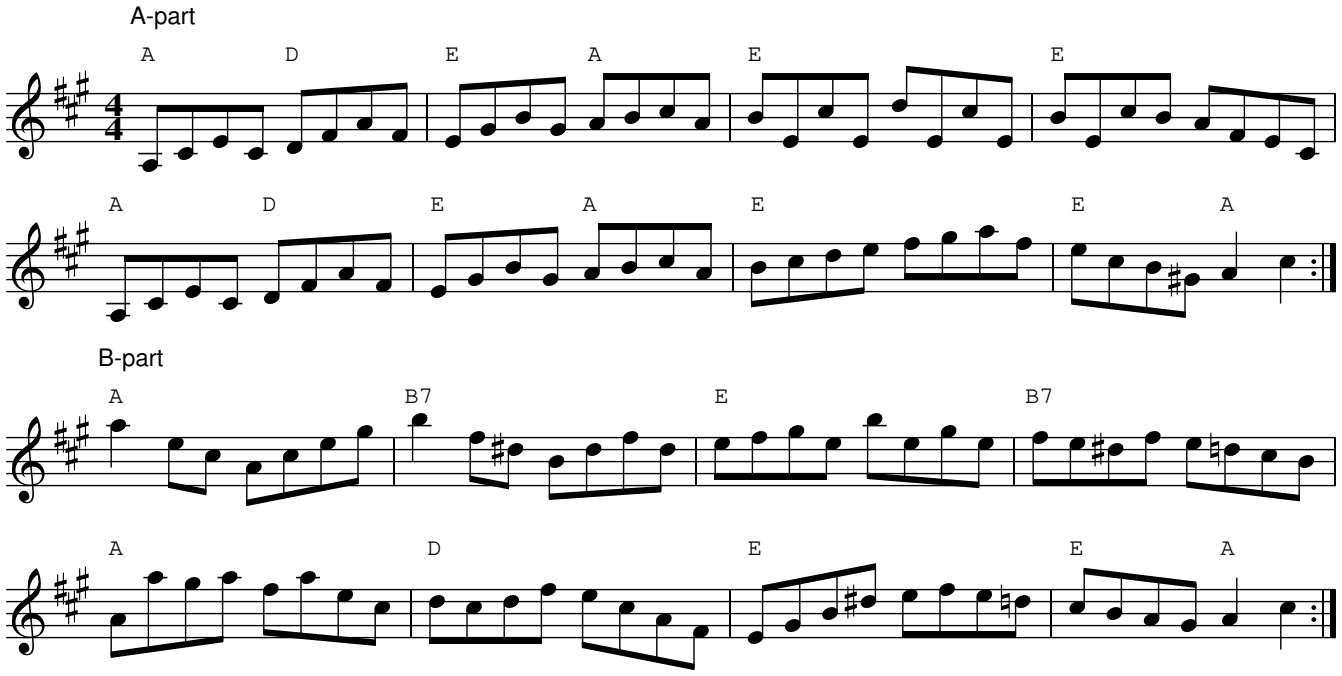
Chords: A/G A A E7 | A/G A G/E7 A :| Am/G Am Am E7 | Am/G Am Am G/Am

Source: _Kentucky Open Band Contra Tunes_, with some original variations.

Notes: Great jam tune. For inspiration, see https://youtu.be/912wUcMXG_0?feature=shared

Miller's Reel

Trad.
reel

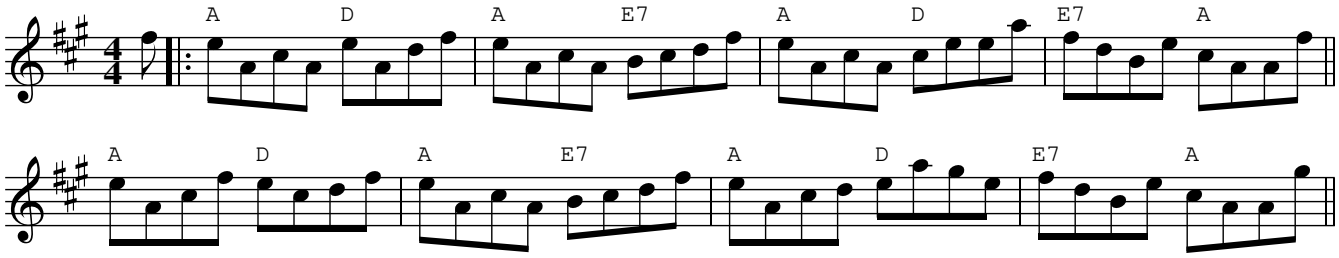


Chords: A/D E/A E E | A/D E/A E E/A :| A B7 E B7 | A D E E/A :|

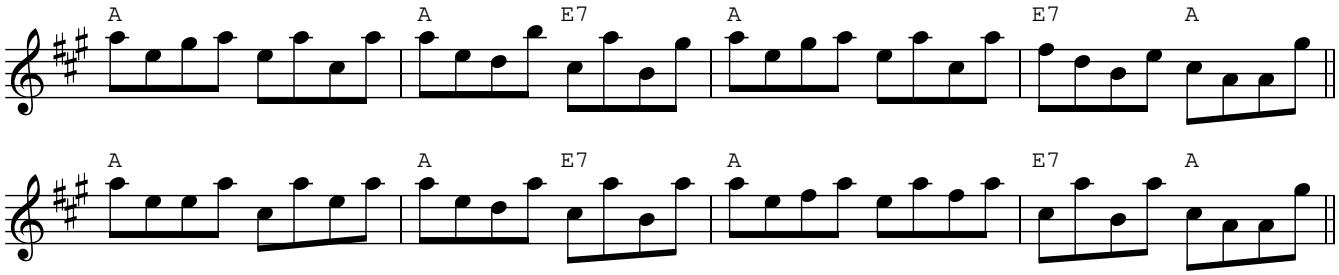
Money Musk

Trad.
reel

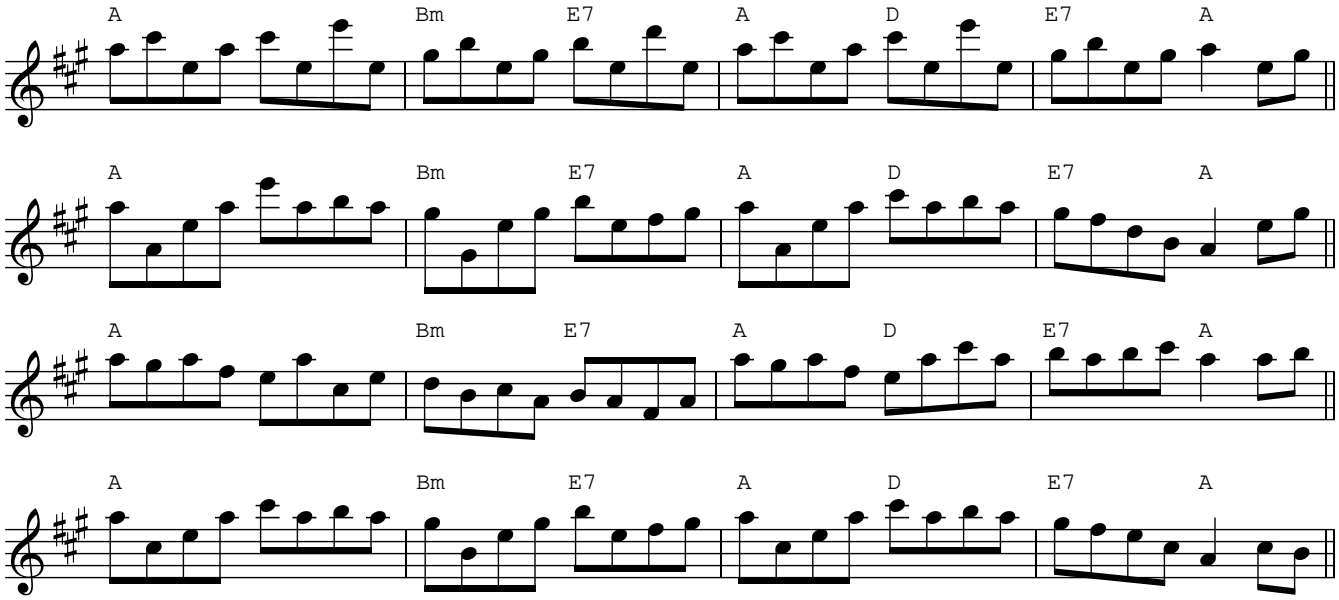
A-part (2 variations)



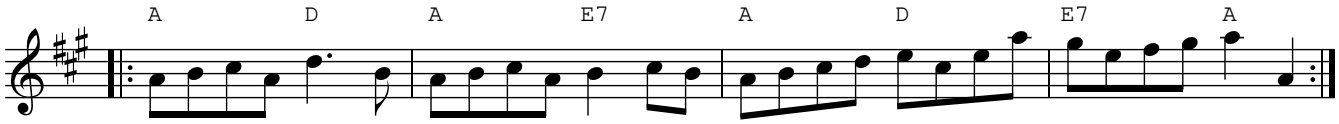
B-part (2 variations)



C-part (4 variations)



D-part



A-part: A/D A/E A/D E/A :| B-part: A A/E7 A E7/A :|

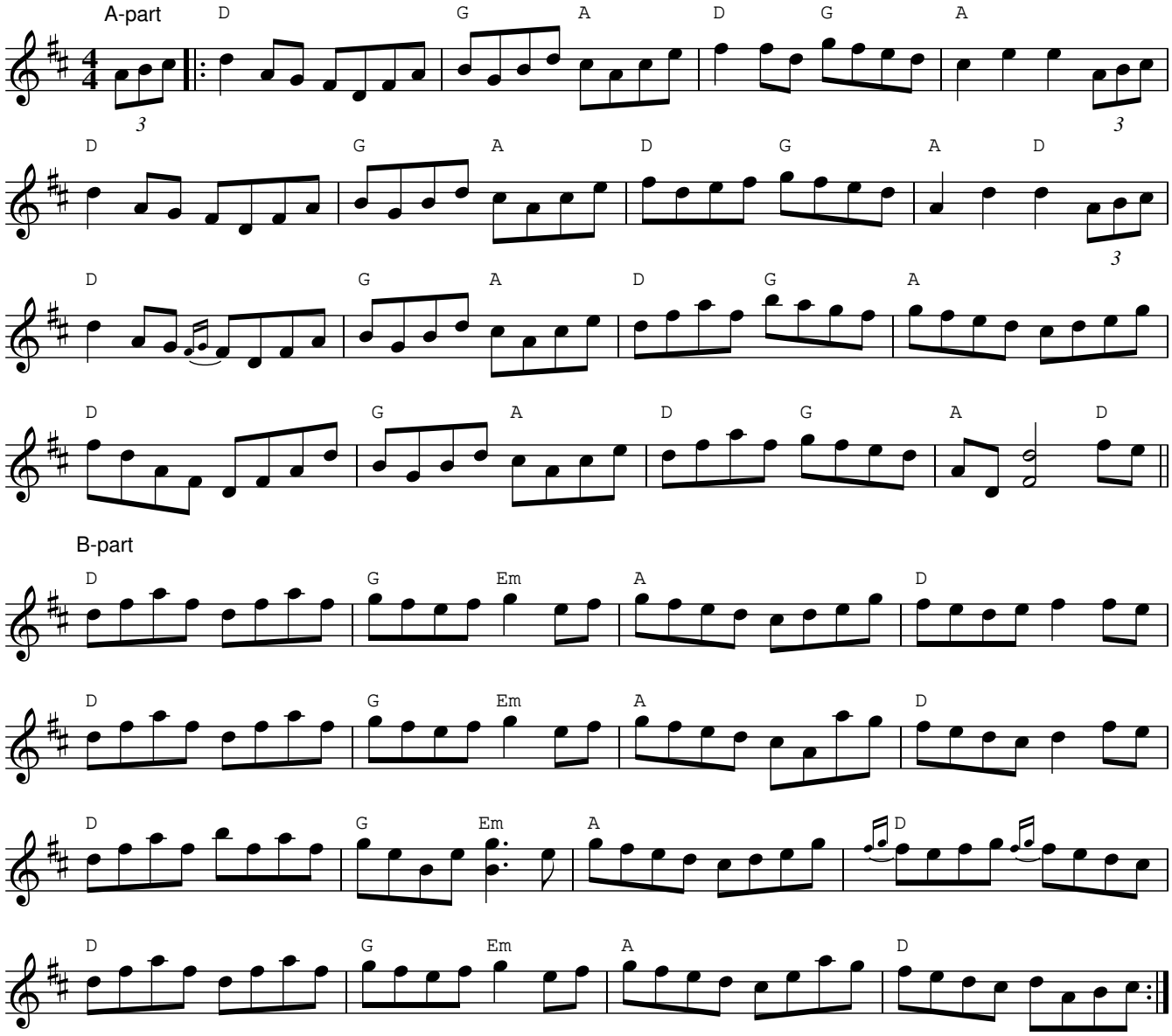
C-part: A Bm/E7 A/D E/A :| D-part: A/D A/E A/D E/A :|

Source: _The Fiddler's Bible_ for the base, plus variations by Tom Wiesgerber.

Notes: Great tune with oodles of variations! Choose your favorite version(s) of A, B, and C, then play: Ax2 > Bx2 > Cx2 or D (some play both) > repeat from the top.

The Morpeth Rant

William Sheild
rant



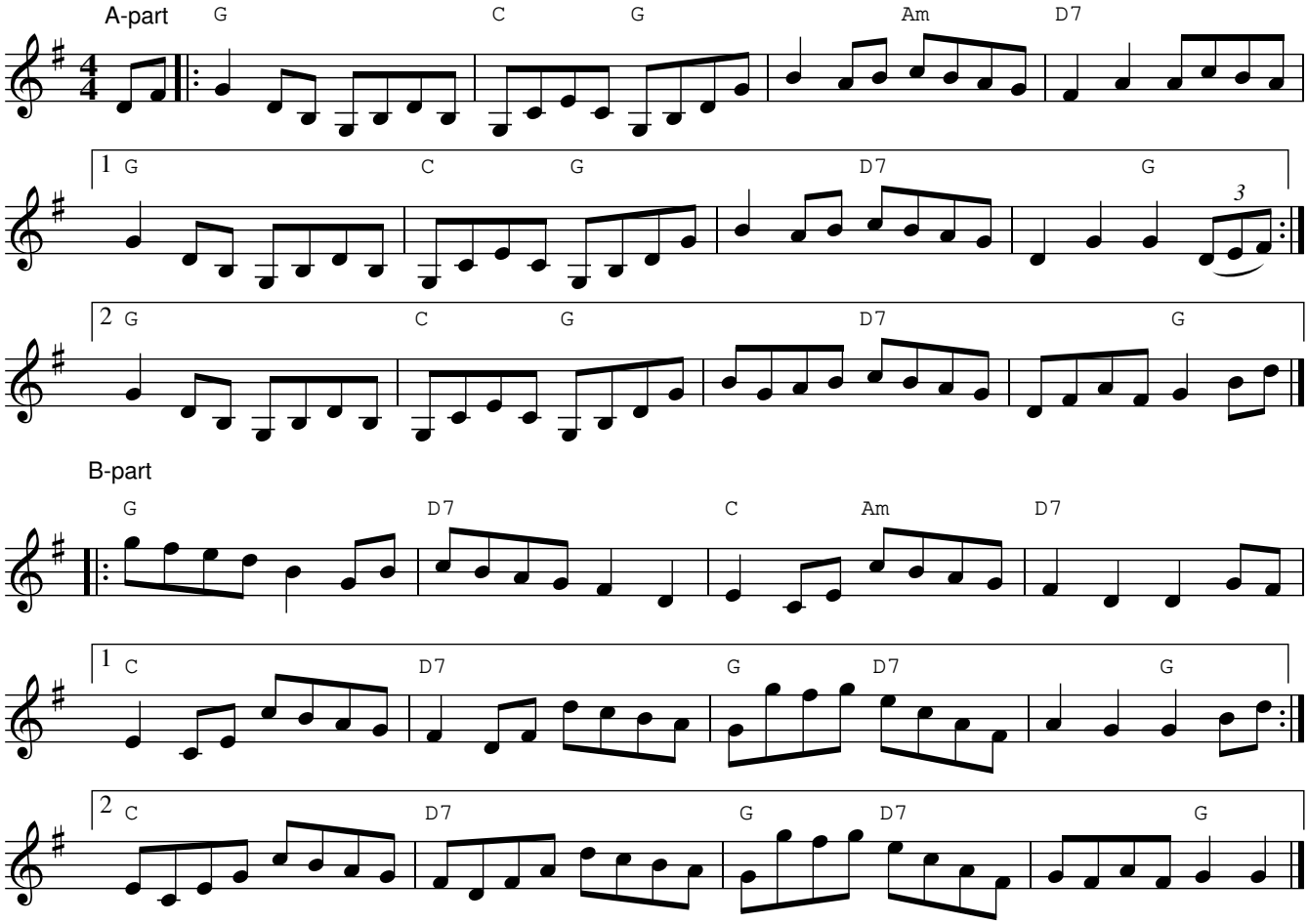
Chords: D G/A D/G A7 | D G/A D/G A/D :| D G/Em A D | D G/Em A D :|

Source: Stewart Hardy, https://youtu.be/ogZMXmpvqh4?si=OReaCGFonFyUaiGt.

Notes: The unofficial "national" tune of Northumbria. It is popular to play this in a set with The Old Morpeth Rant and Roxburgh Castle.

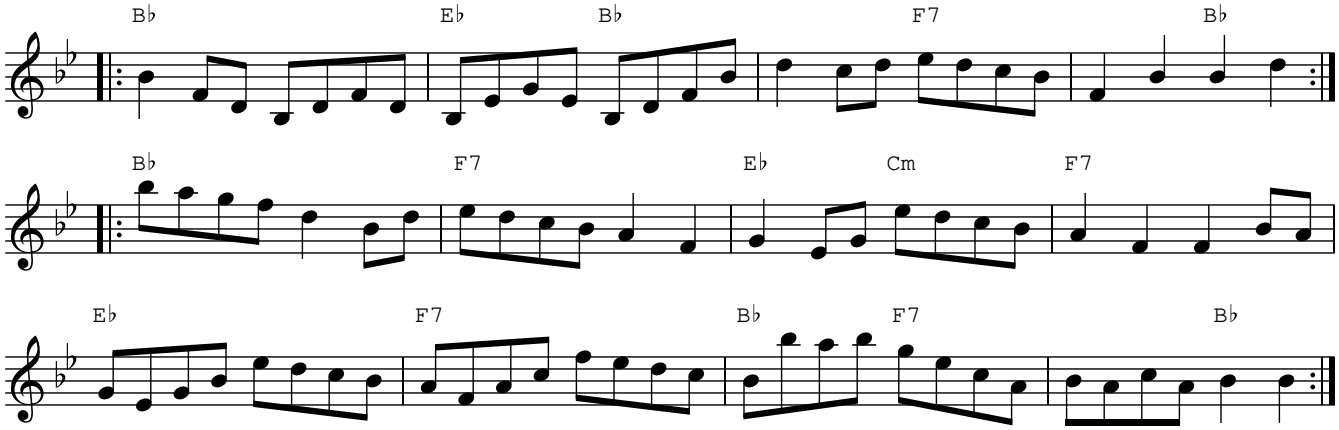
The Old Morpeth Rant

Trad.
rant



Chords: G C/G G/Am D7 | G C/G D7 D7/G :| G D7 C/Am D7 | C D7 G/D7 D7/G

It is also played in Bb! Here is the skeleton version:

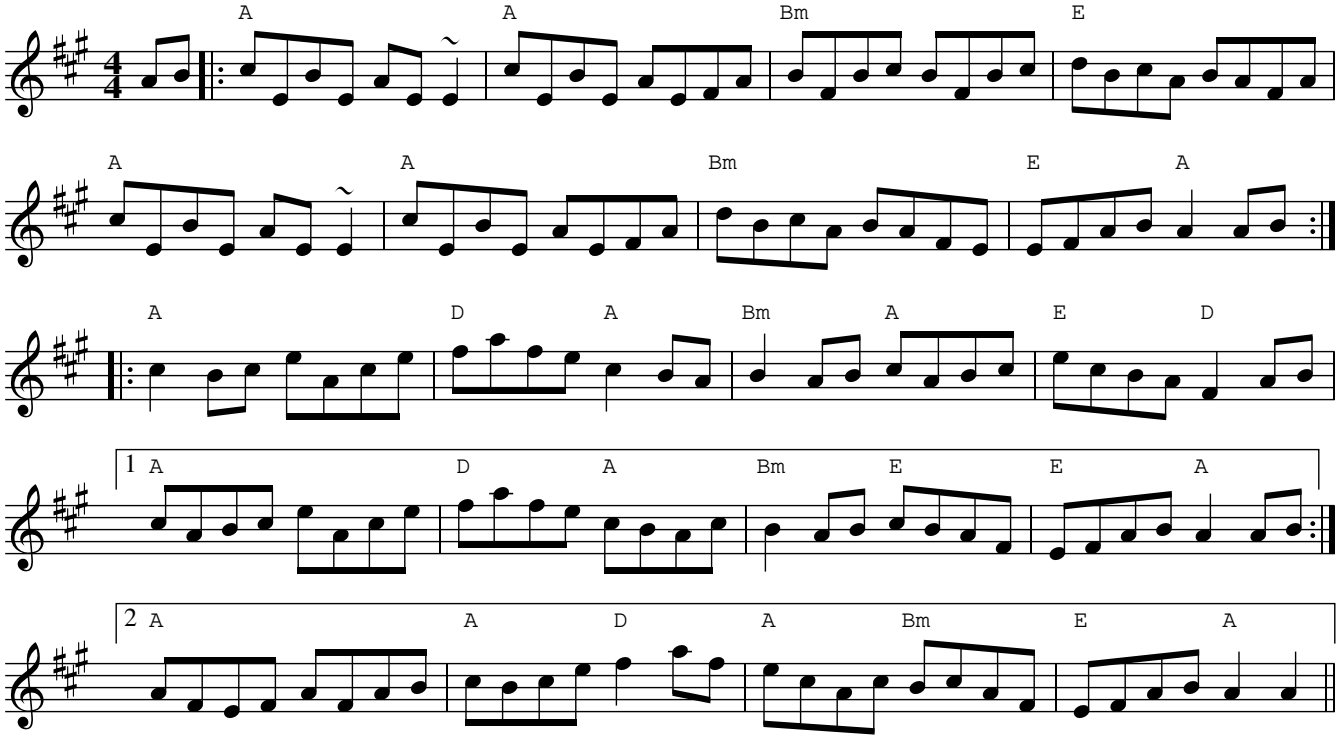


Source: Stewart Hardy, https://youtu.be/d0AWDc_zuK0?si=Nra7JSgGlfhzKS1A.

Notes: More regional interest: the rant is a local form, connected with the Rapper Sword dance; "musically it is similar to a reel, though somewhat slower, and with more of a lilt." (https//en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Music_of_Northumbria)

The Mortgage Burn

Trad.
reel



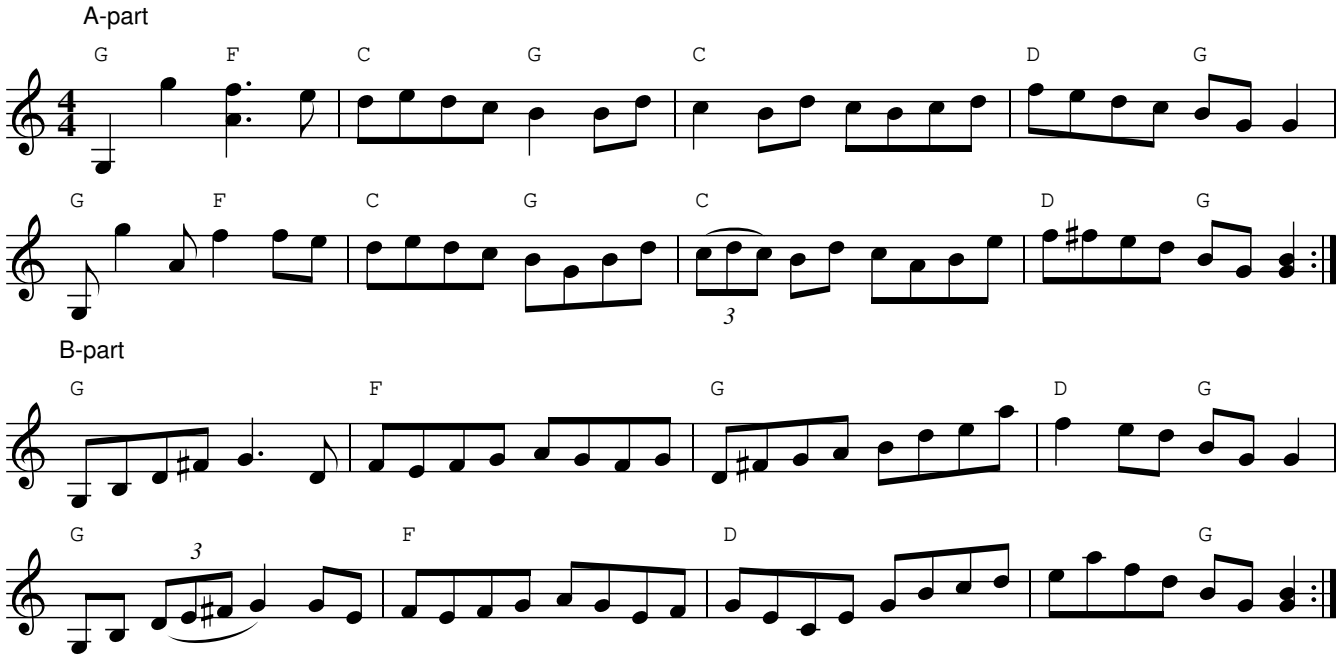
A-part: A A Bm E7 | A A Bm E7/A :|

B-part: A D/A Bm/A E/D | A D/A Bm/E E/A | A D/A Bm/A E/D | A A/D A/Bm E/A

Source: https://thesession.org/tunes/2047

New Reel

Dale Morris
reel



A-part: G/F C/G C D/G :| G F G D/G | G F D D/G :|

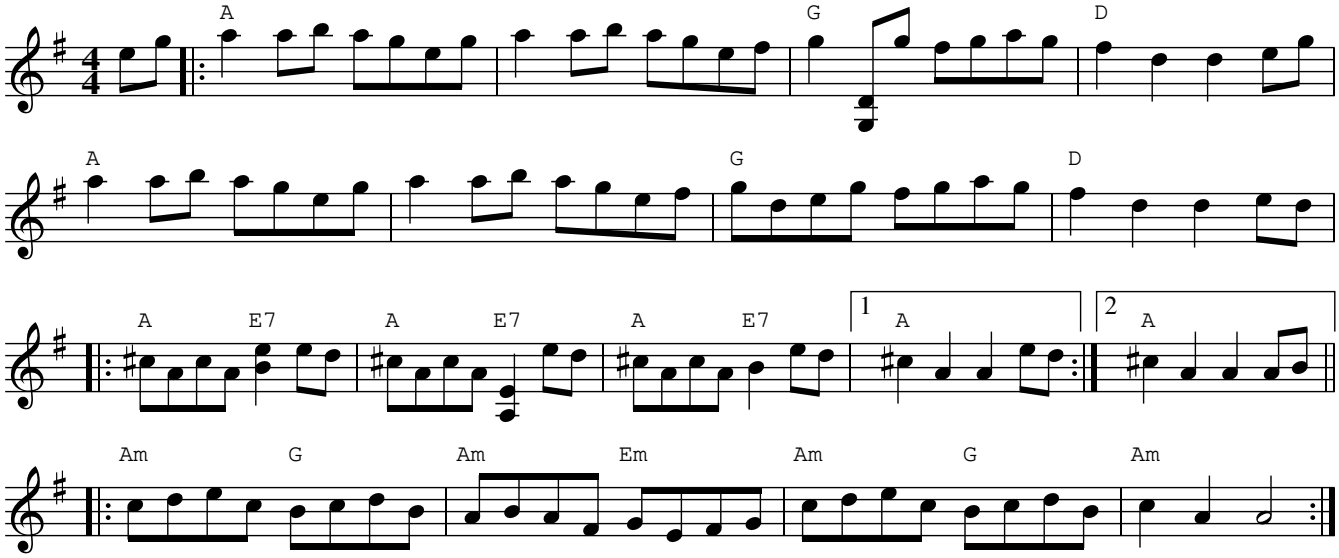
Notes: A somewhat mysterious tune I found amongst the practice / lesson tapes from Dale Morris that my teacher passed on to me. I only have it down as "New Reel" (was it Dale's composition?), but it might be a traditional tune.

da New Rigged Ship + Shelder Geo

pronounced "gyo"

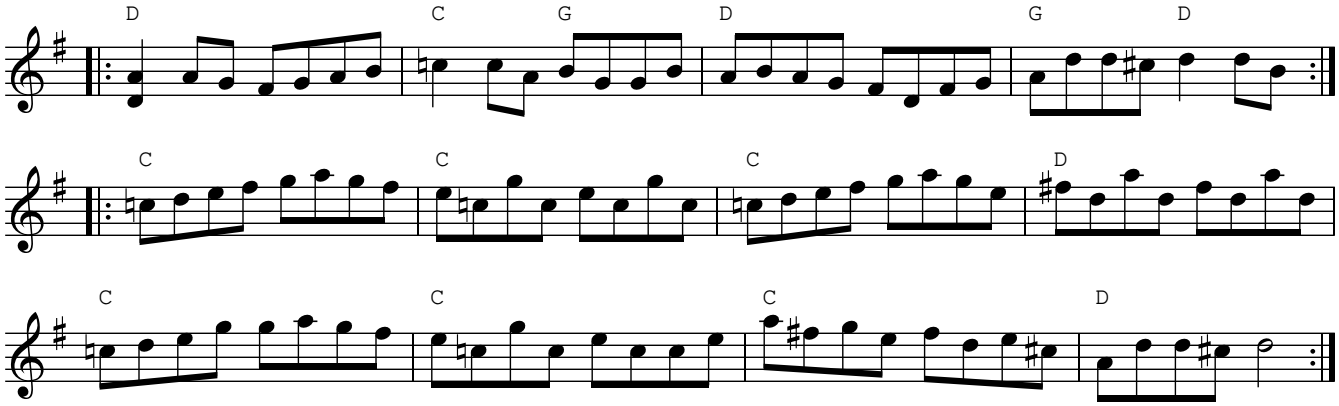
Trad.
reel

da New Rigged Ship



Chords: A A G D :| A/E7 A/E7 A/E7 A :| Am/G Am/Em Am/G Am :|

Shelder Geo



Chords: D C/G D G/D :| C C C D :|

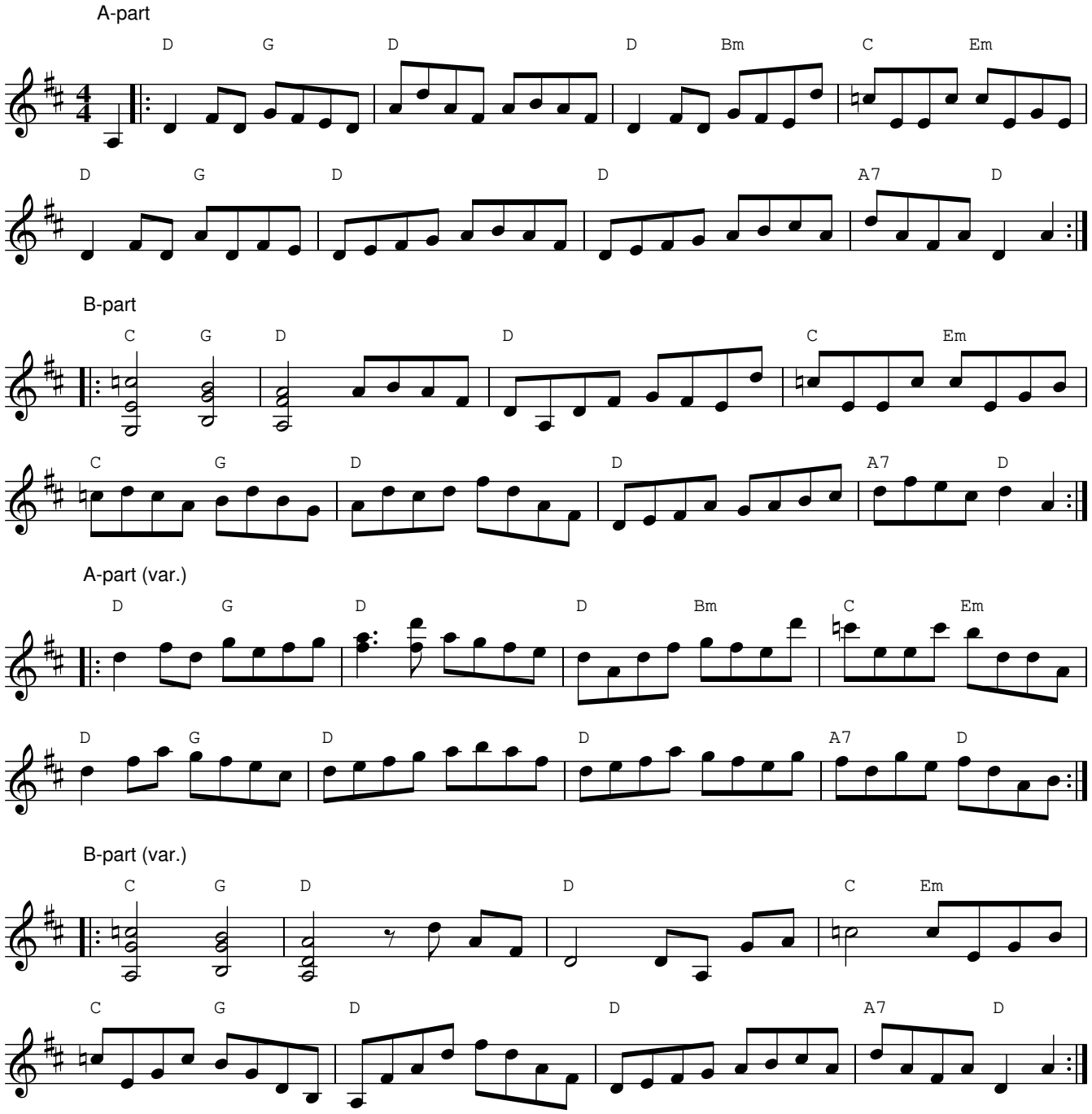
Source: Maggie Sansone (Mist and Stone, 1990).

Notes: This set segues nicely to Sleep Soond i da Moarnin.

The Nine Points of Roguery

a.k.a. The Black Mare of Fanad

Trad.
reel



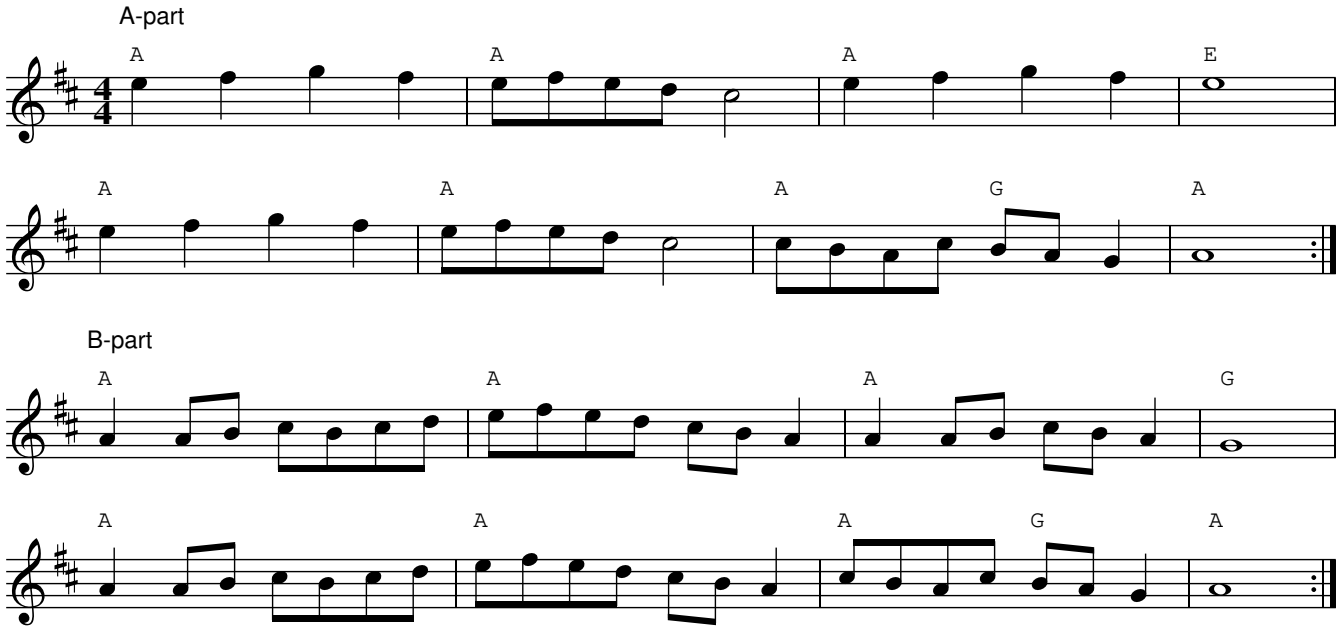
Chords: D/G D D/Bm C/Em | D/G D D A7/D :| C/G D D/Bm C/Em | C/G D D A7/D :|

Source: Maggie Sansone (Mist and Stone, 1990) plus bits of thesession.org/tunes/429 and my own additions.

Notes: It seems many versions of this tune place an Em chord in the fourth bar of both parts. Maggie goes to a C instead, and I like that.

Old Joe Clark

Trad.
reel

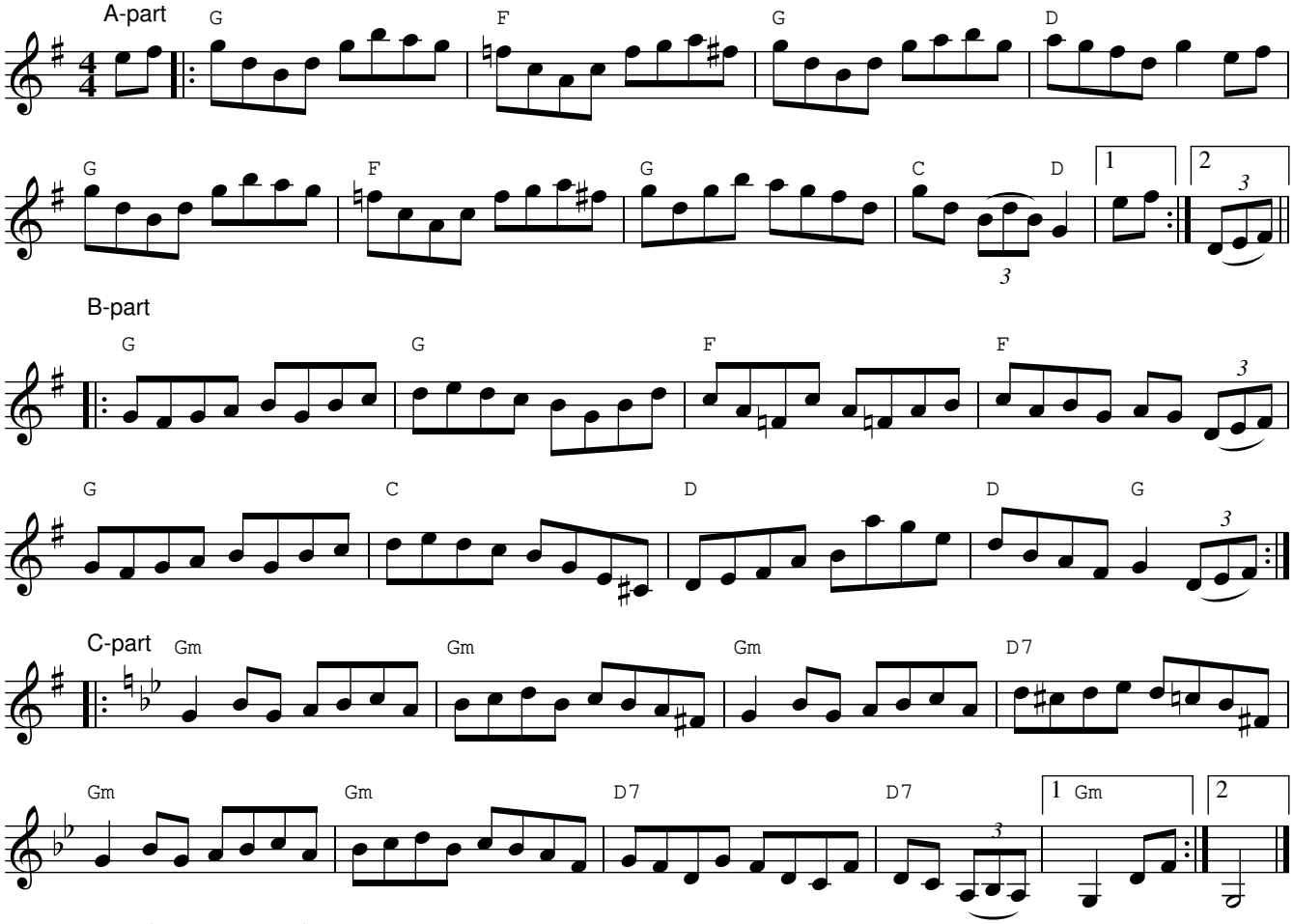



```
A-part == | B-part ==
A A A · E | A A A · G
A A A/G A | A A A/G A
```

Notes: This is a popular bluegrass tune. Here is a simple version I got from a mandolin lesson.
Will work with this more in the future.

Old Straw Bonnet

Trad.
reel

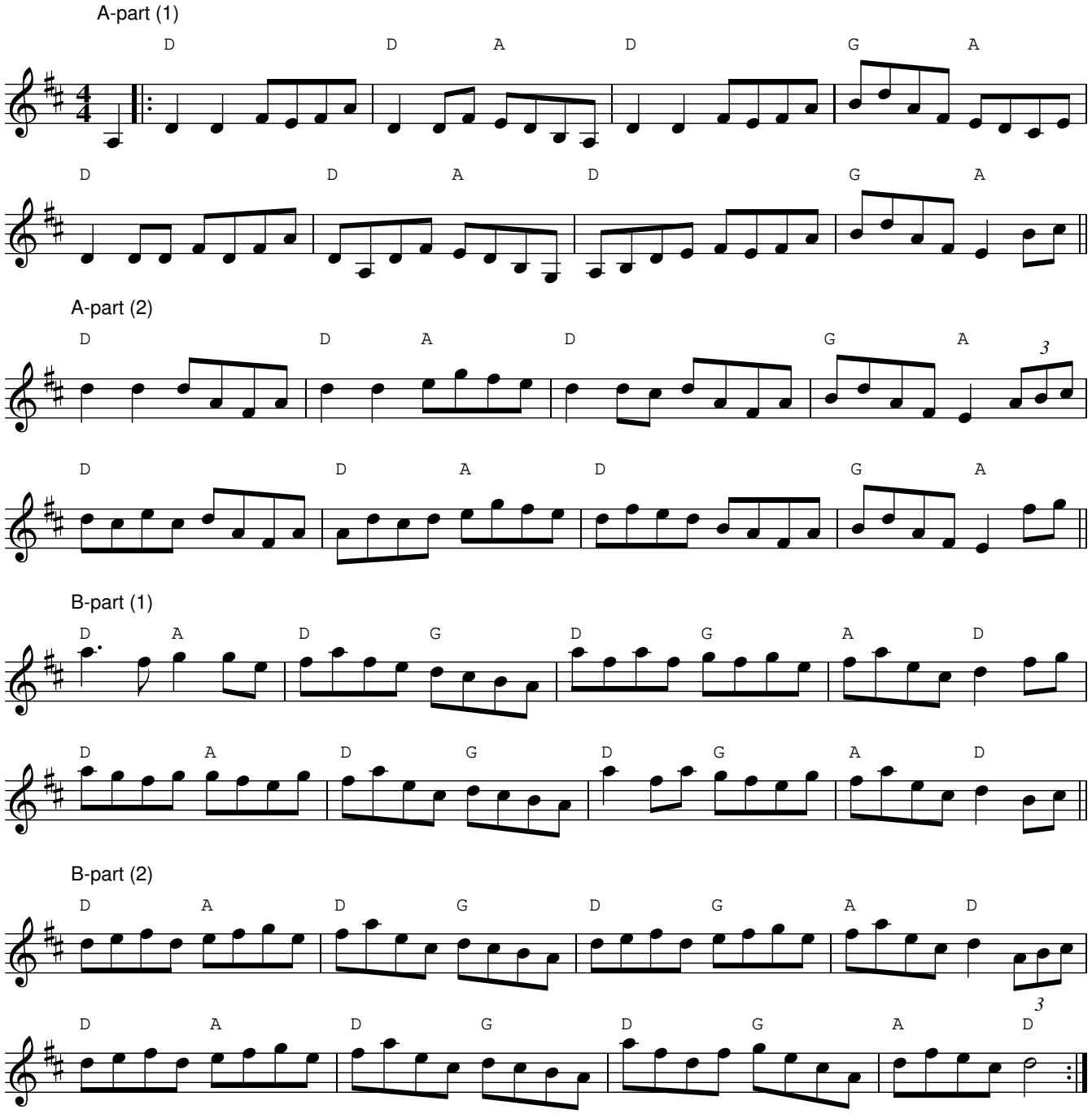



```
A-part === | B-part == | C-part ====
G F G D7 · | G G F F · | Gm Gm Gm D7
G F G D7/G | G C D D/G | Gm Gm D7 D7/Gm
```

Notes: Great tune; this is the basic way I play it.

Opera Reel

Trad.
reel



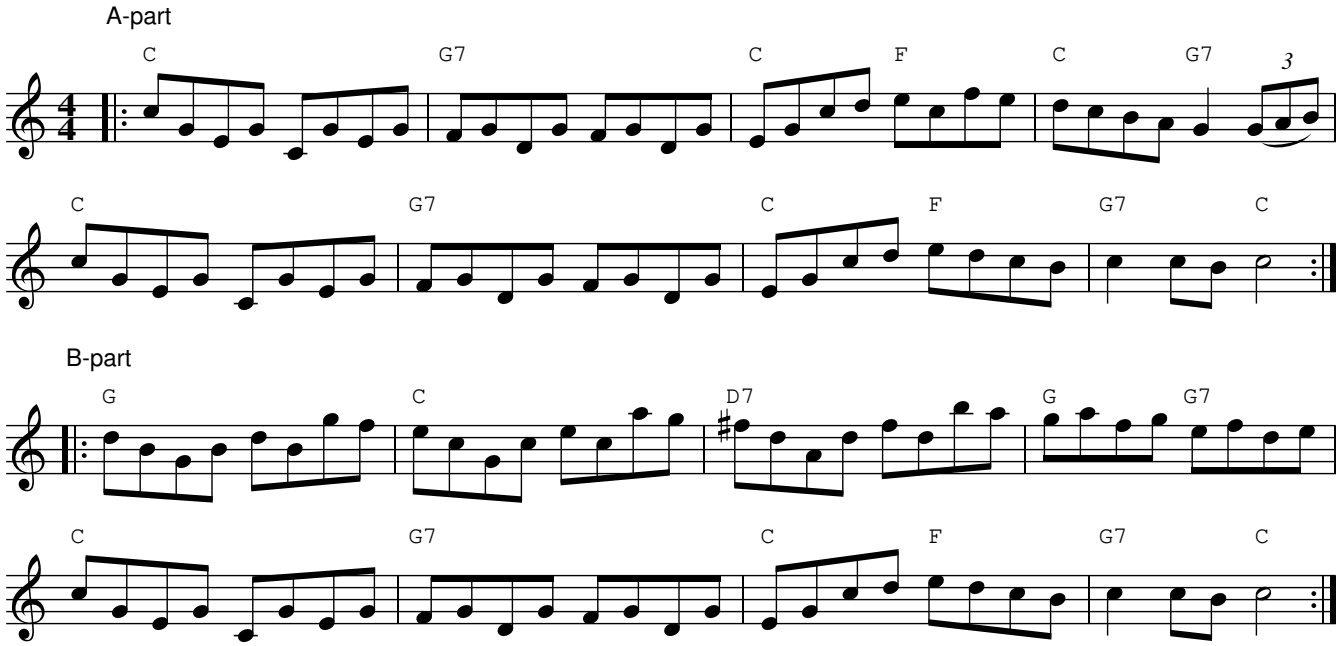

```
A-part ==== | B-part ========
D D/A D G/A | D/A D/G D/G A/D
D D/A D G/A | D/A D/G D/G A/D
```

Source: _KY Contra Tunes_ and some online variants

Notes: This is interesting! Basically the usual A and B parts, but each part seems to have distinct variations on each. Also neat that the A part resolves on the dominant instead of the tonic.

Peerless Hornpipe

Trad.
hornpipe

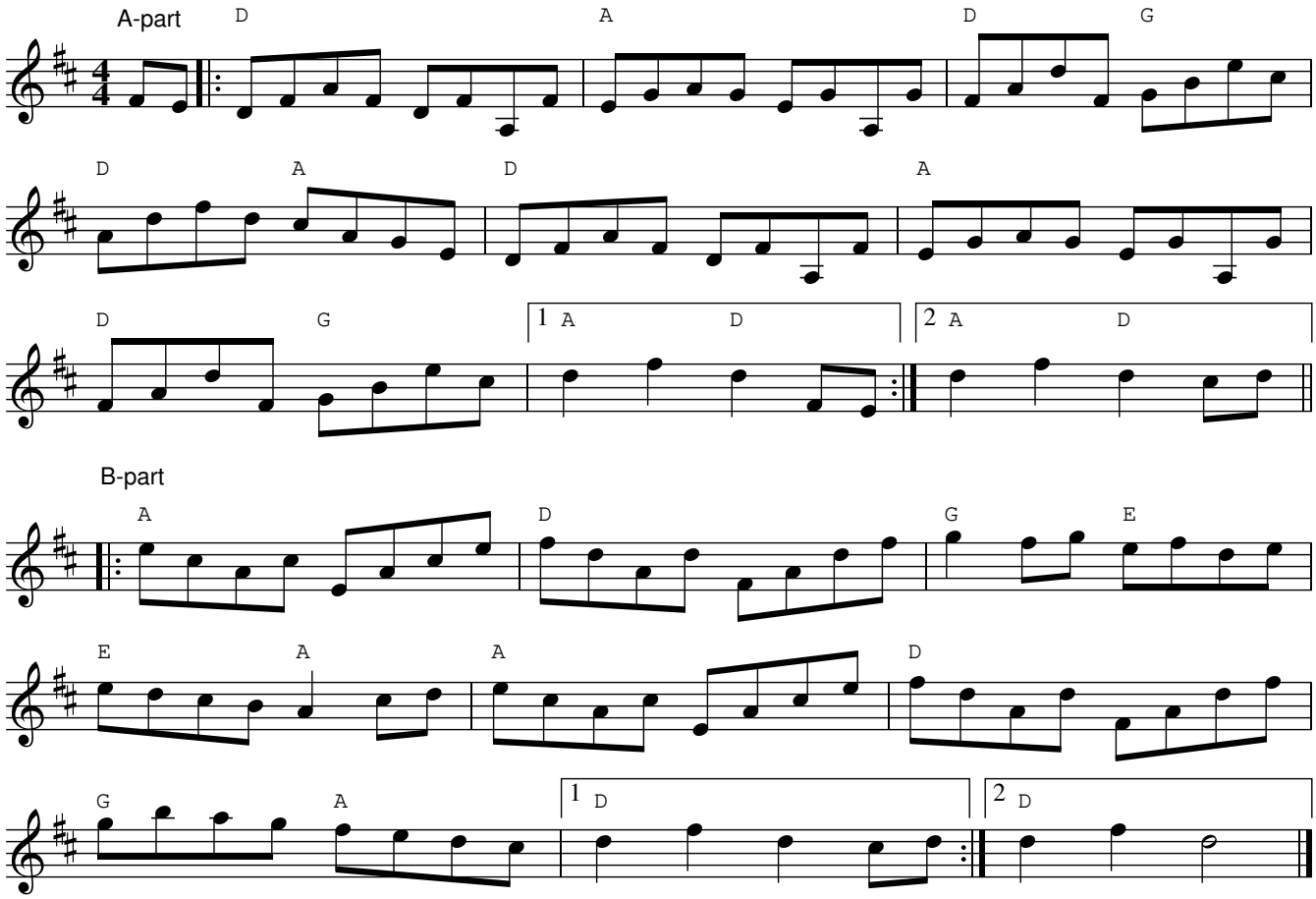


Chords: G C/G G/Am D7 | G C/G D7 D7/G :| G D7 C/Am D7 | C D7 G/D7 D7/G :|

Source: _The Fiddler's Bible_.

Queen of the West

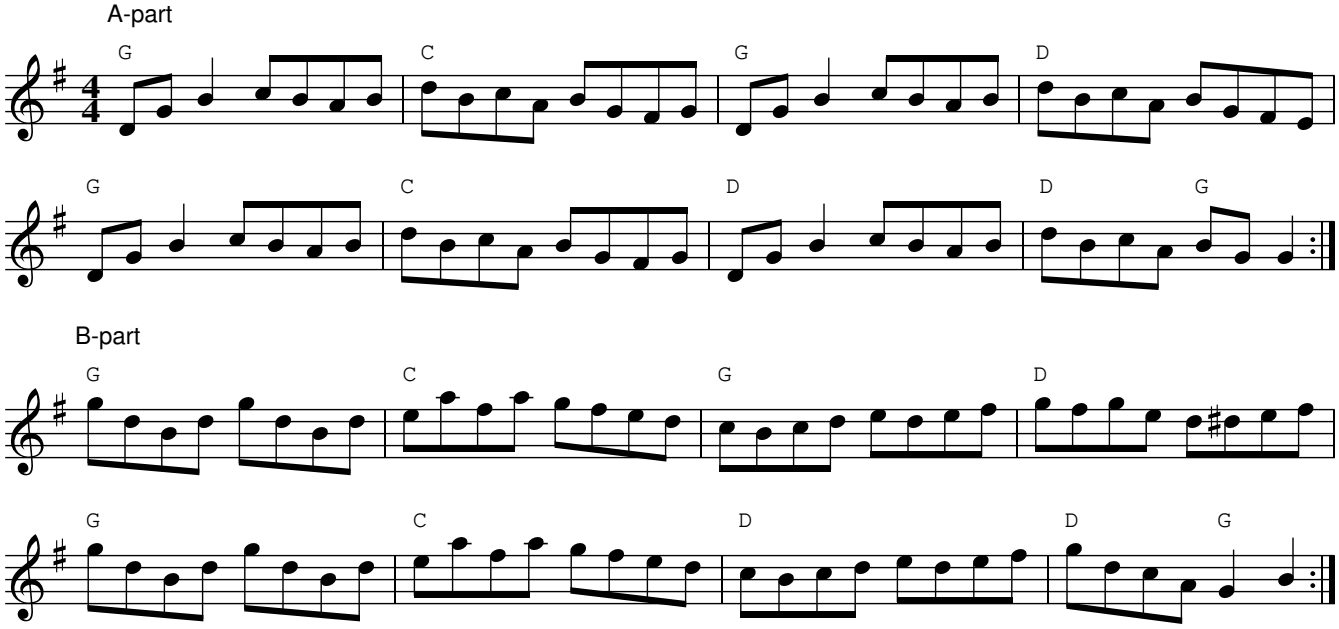
Trad.
reel



Chords: D A D/G D/A | D A D/G A/D :| A D G/E E/A | A D G/A D :|

Rackety Jack's Reel

Trad.
reel

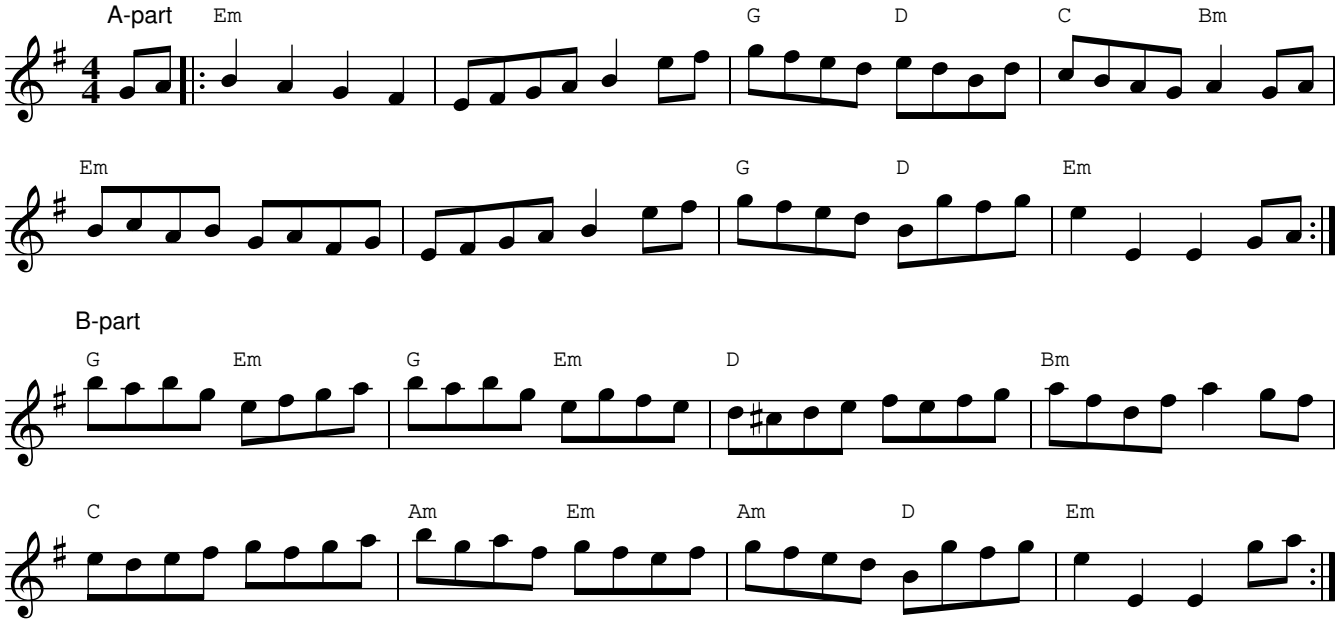


Chords: G C G D | G C D/G :|

Source: _The Fiddler's Bible_.

The Rights of Man

Trad.
hornpipe

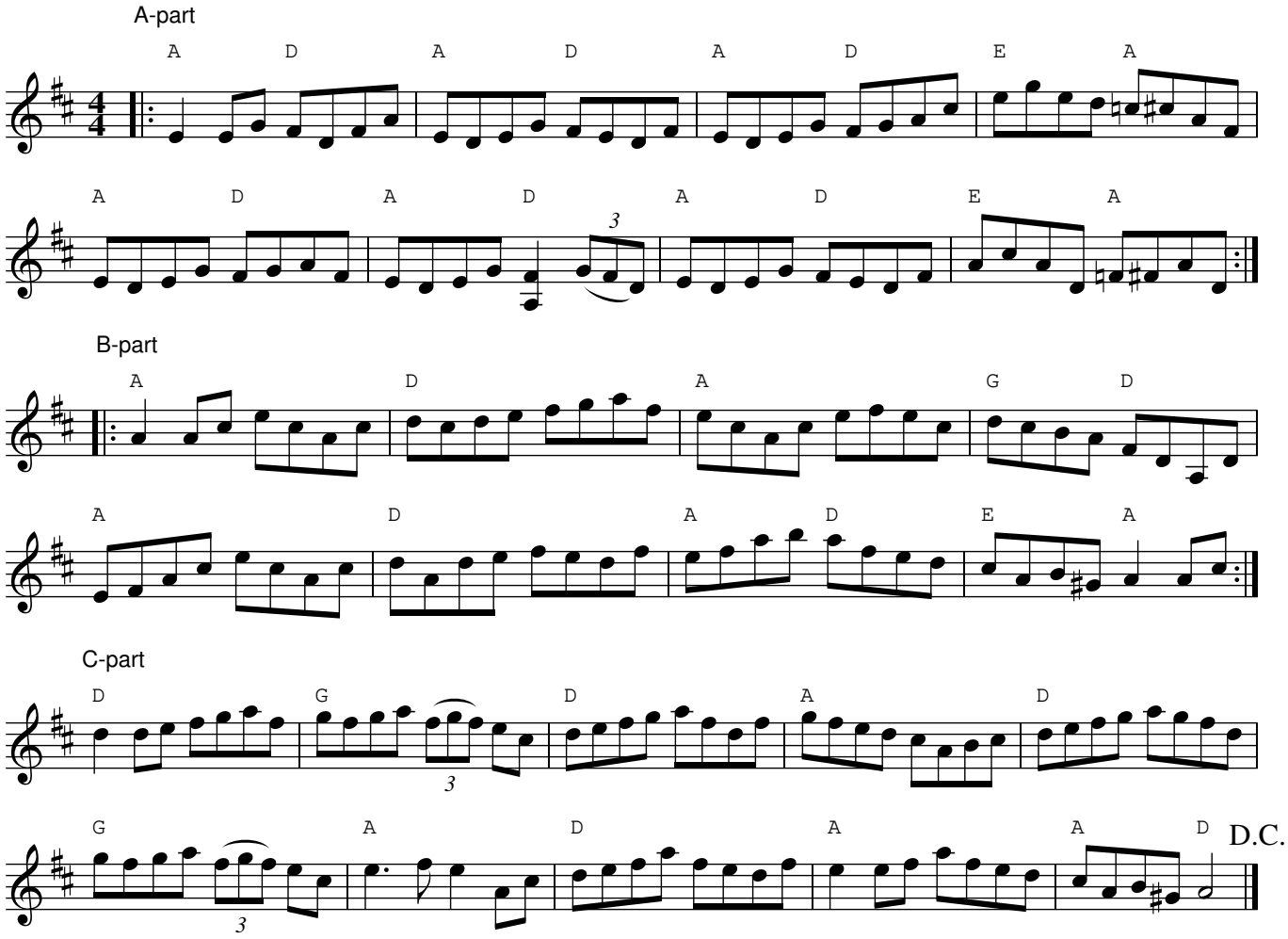


Chords: Em Em G/D C/Bm | Em Em G/D Em :| G/Em G/Em D Bm | C Am/Em Am/D Em :|

Notes: Popularly paired with The Democratic Hornpipe.
Also features in the set: King of Fairies > Off to California > Rights of Man.

Rye Straw (D)

Trad.
reel



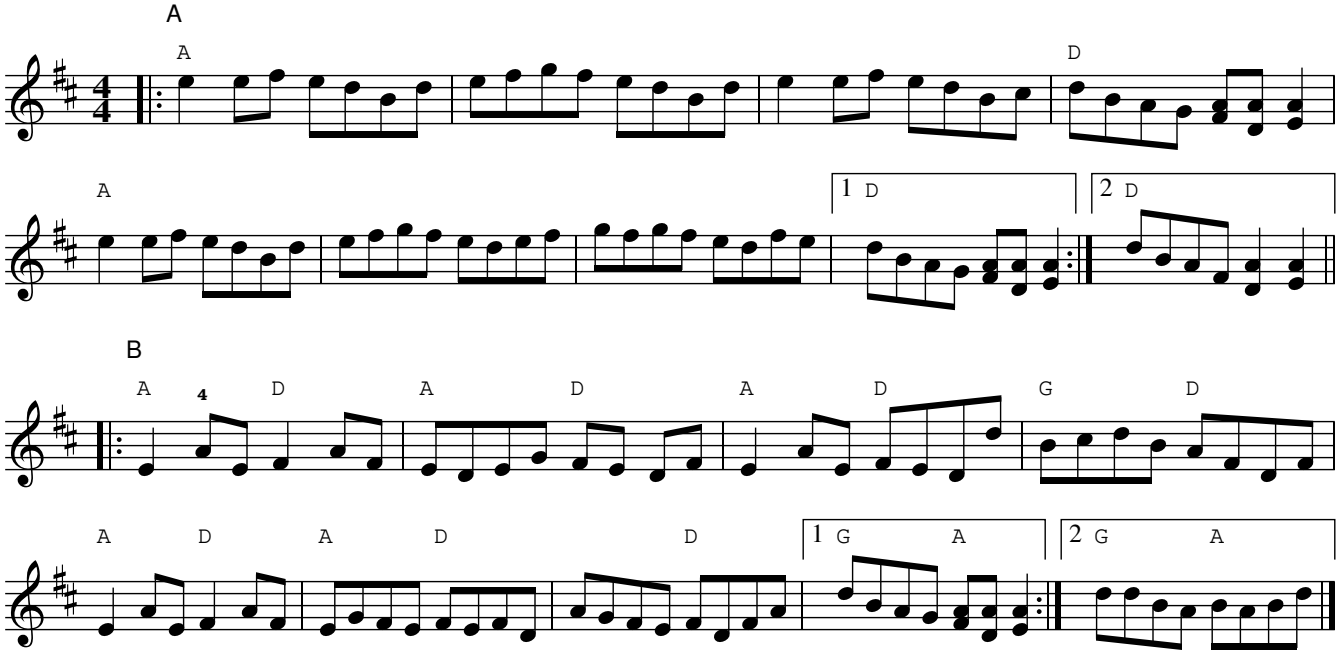
A-part ======== | B-part ==== | C-part ====
A/D A/D A/D E/A | A D A · G/D | D G D A
A/D A/D A/D E/A | A D A/D E/A | D G A D [A A/D]

Source: Todd Phillips + Darol Anger, In the Pines (1995) [with many modifications]

Notes: Rye Straw seems to have a zillion variations. The core of this version draws from Darol Anger's arrangement, where he seems to mash the 16 bars of one of its usual B-parts to create a 'bridge' C-part of 10 bars. It's pretty neat!

Rye Straw (D var.)

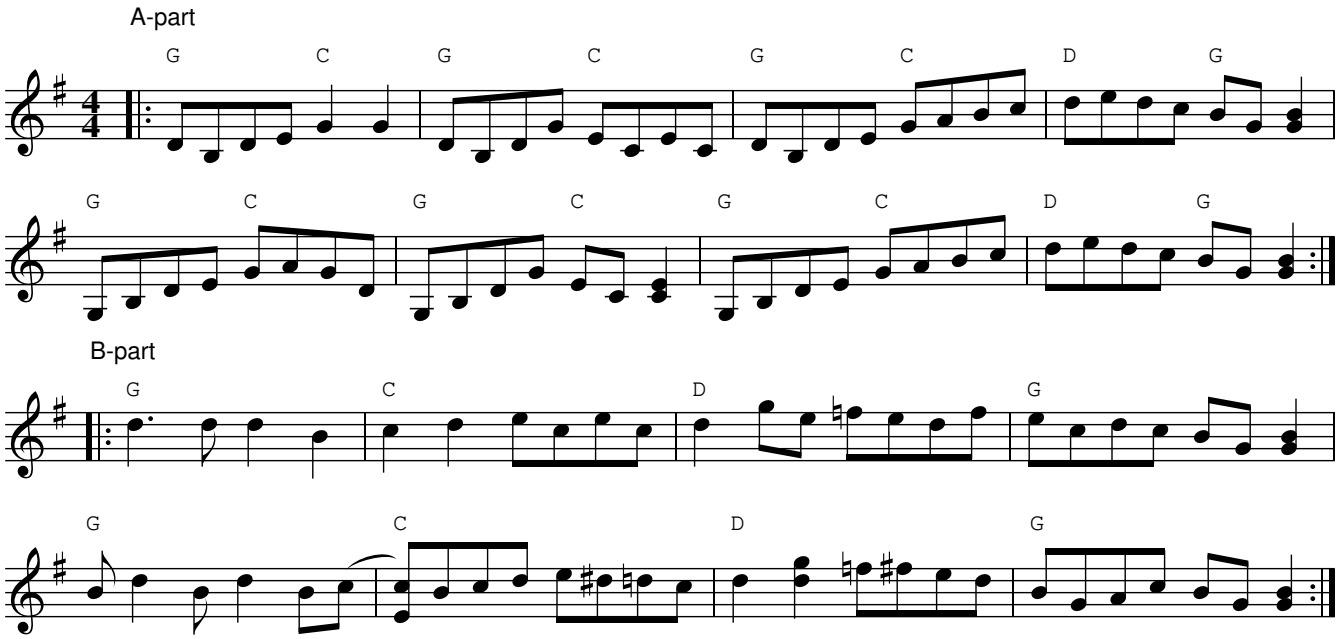
Trad. + Dave Notman
reel



Notes: A version of Rye Straw heavily modified by Dave Notman.

Rye Straw (G)

Trad.
reel



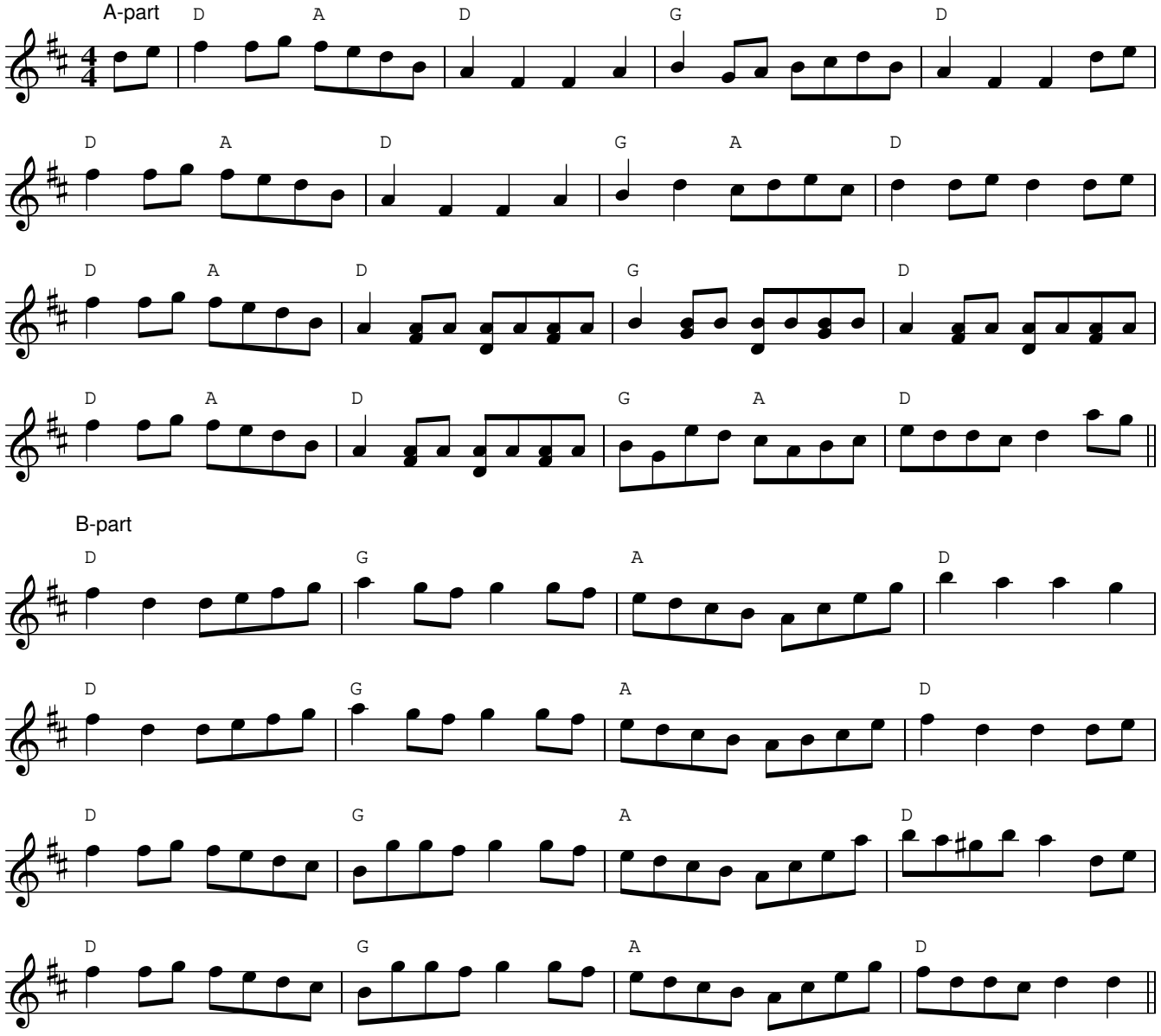
Chords: G/C G/C G/C D/G :| G C D G :|

Source: Doc Roberts, followed by a few variations I've heard.

Notes: Note about the chords - this can easily follow a straight G pattern, but I kind of like the "rocking" pattern between G and C on the A part that I've heard in other versions.

Saint Anne's Reel

Trad.
reel

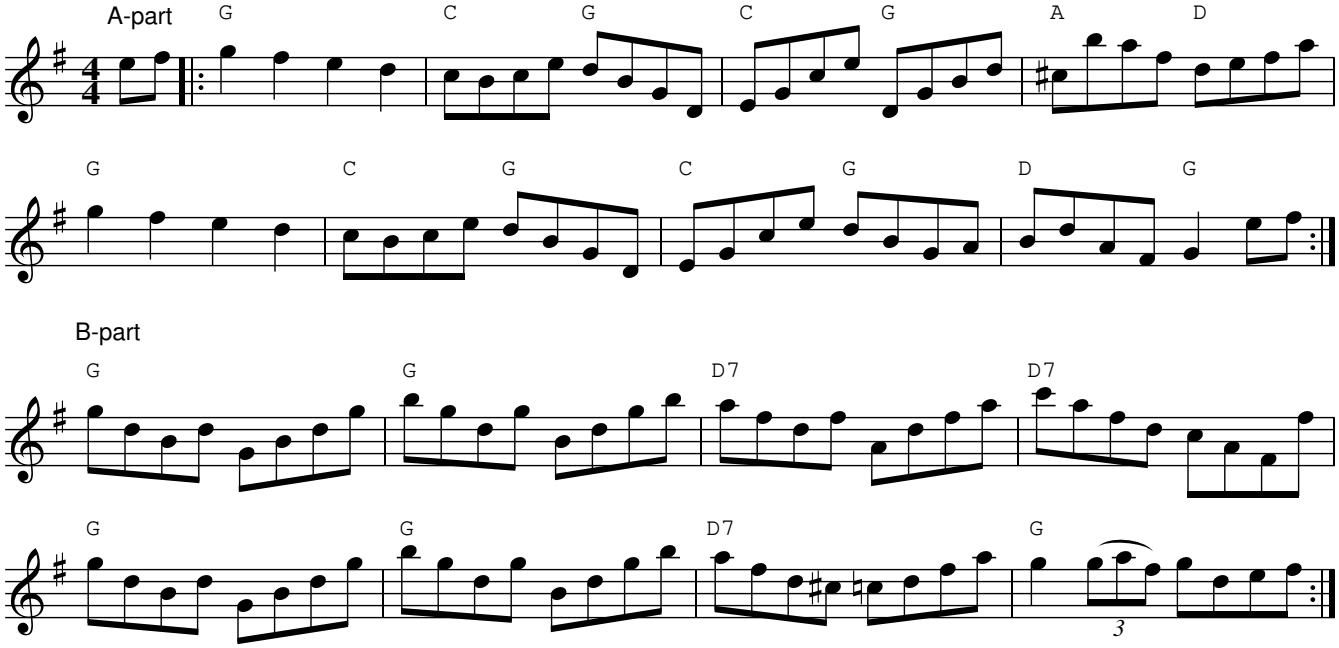


A-part ==== | B-part=
D/A D G · D | D G A D
D/A D G/A D | D G A D

Source: A combination of two versions at thesession.org/tunes/103
Notes: A rather jaunty tune, with a nice melody. Something to explore?

Sally Growler

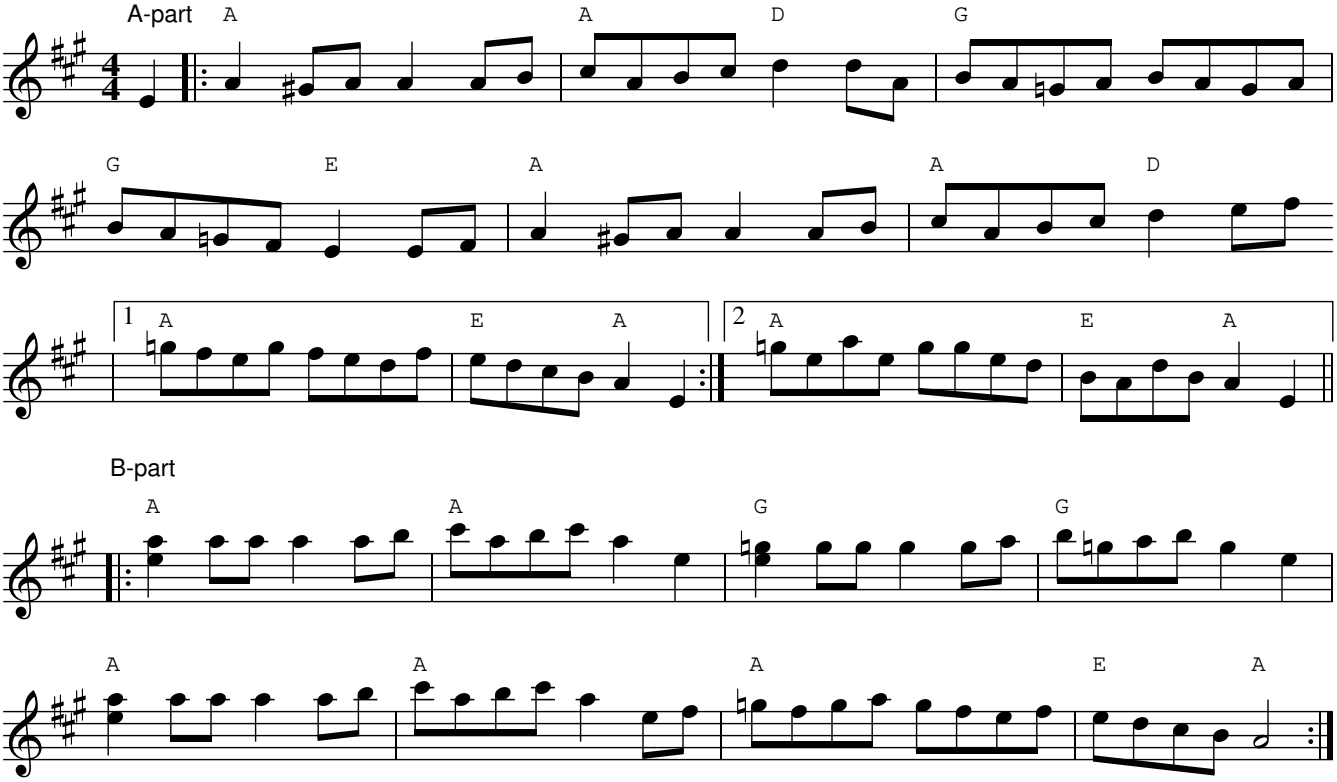
Trad.
reel



Chords: G C/G C/G A/D | G C/G C/G D/G :| G G D7 D7 | G G D7 G :|

Salt Creek

Trad.
reel



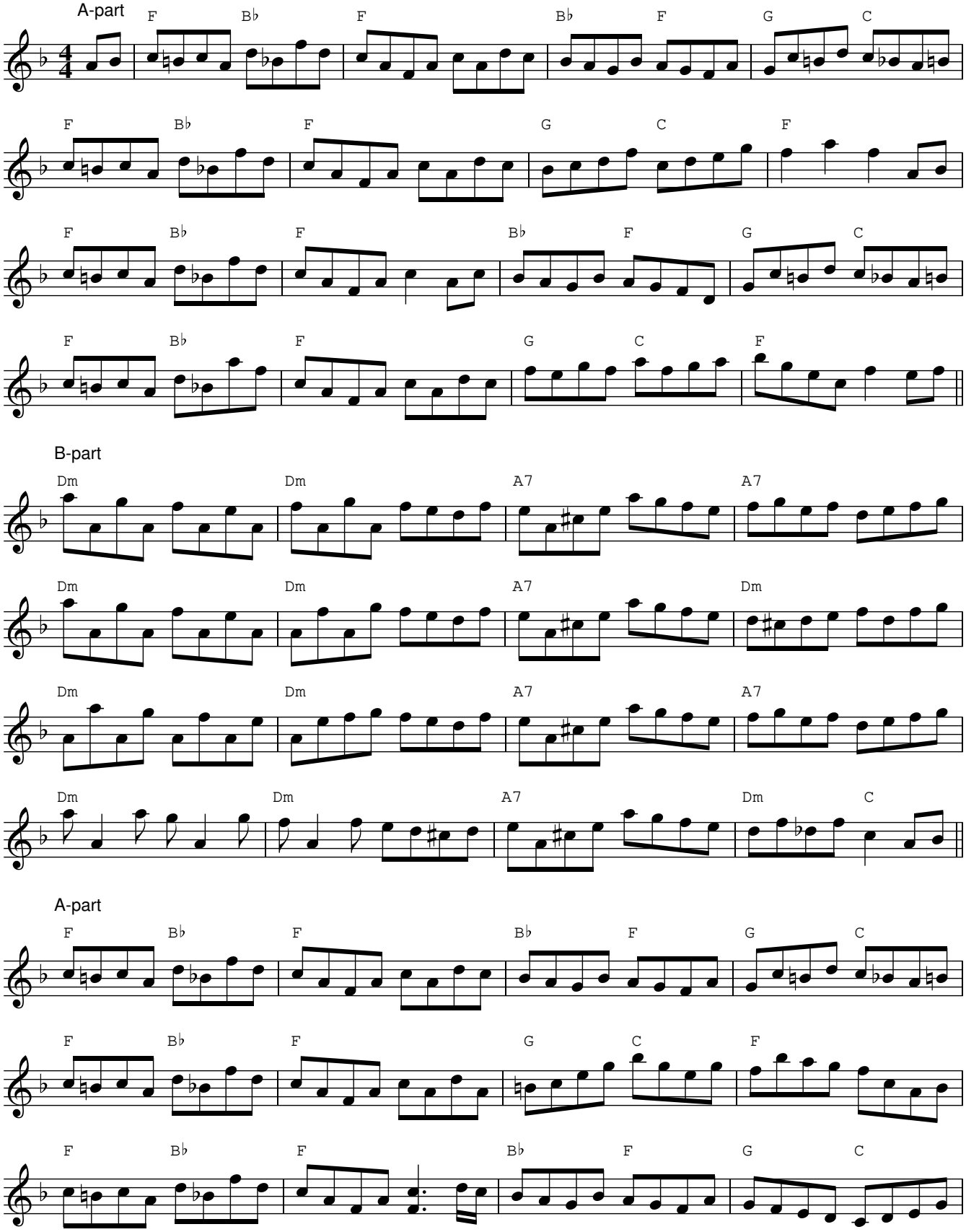
Chords: A A/D G G/E | A A/D A E/A :| A A G G | A A A E/A :|

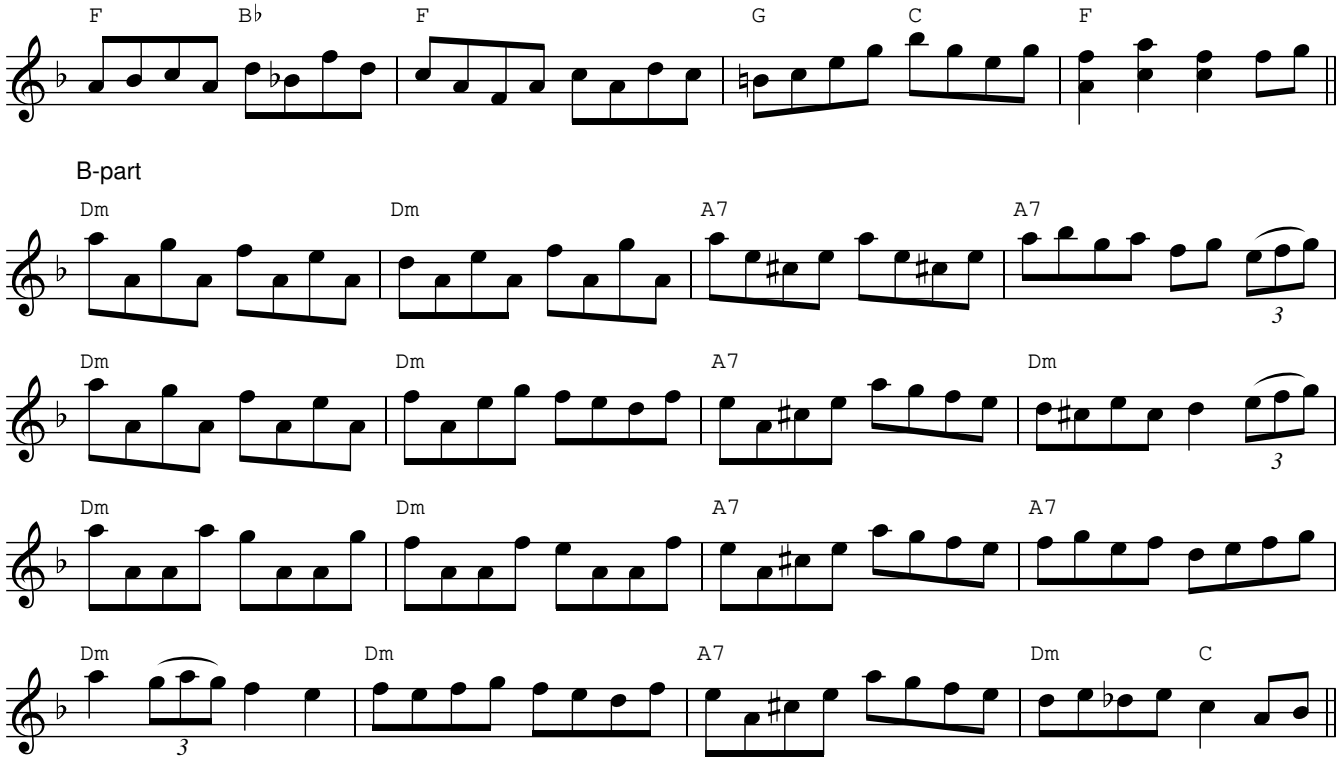
Source: An online intro to mandolin tutorial

Notes: VERY similar to Salt River, but the B-part is different

Saratoga Hornpipe

Trad.
hornpipe






```
A-part ======= | B-part =========
F/Bb F B/F G/C | Dm Dm A7 A7 (3x)
F/Bb F G/C F · | Dm Dm A7 Dm/C
```

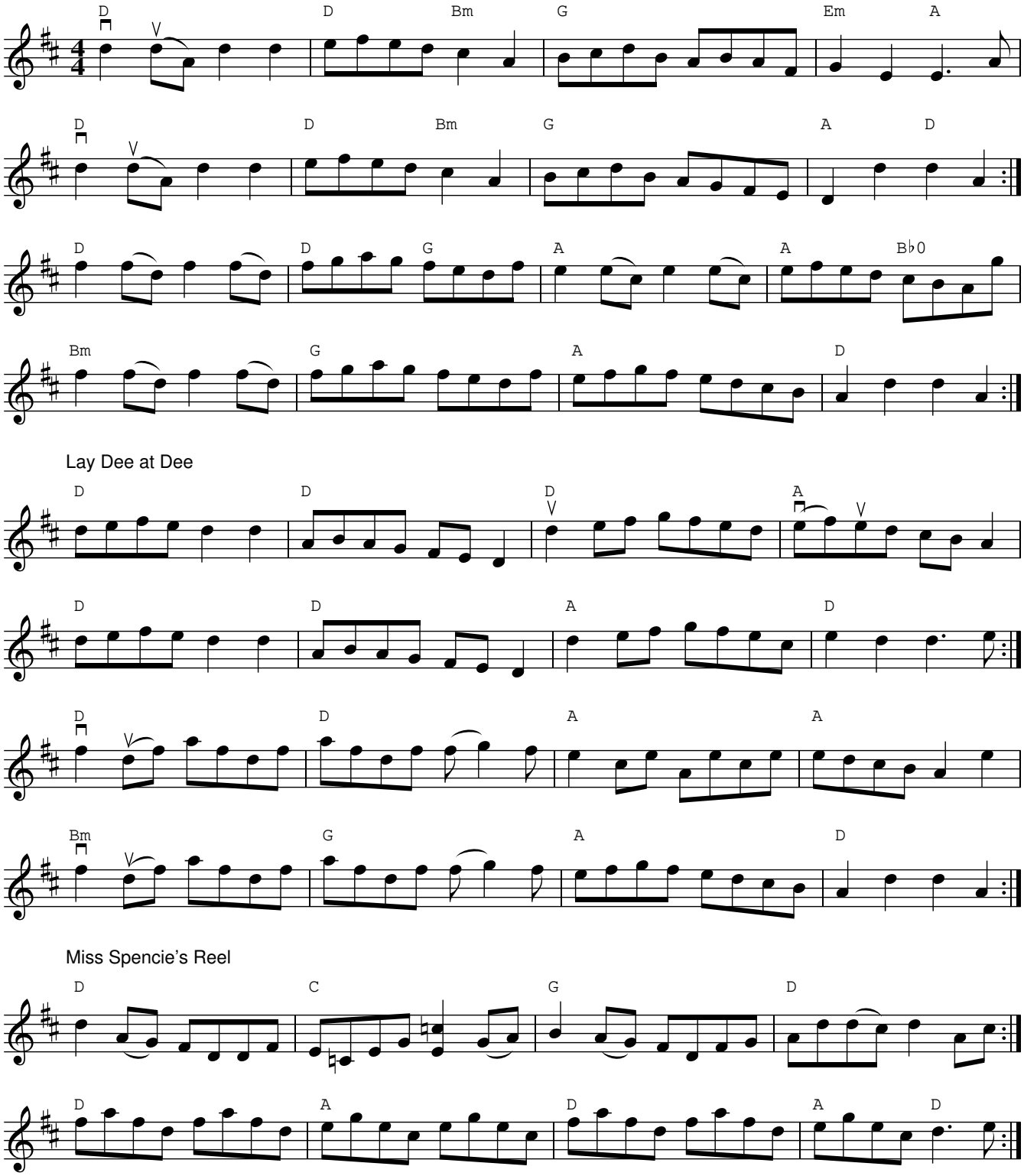
Source: Assembled from versions by Chris Daring, Terry Morris, Christine King, and Tom Weisgerber.
Notes: Great tune. So many great ways to play it.

Shetland Set

da Ferry Reel, Lay Dee at Dee, and Miss Spencie's Reel

Trad.
reel

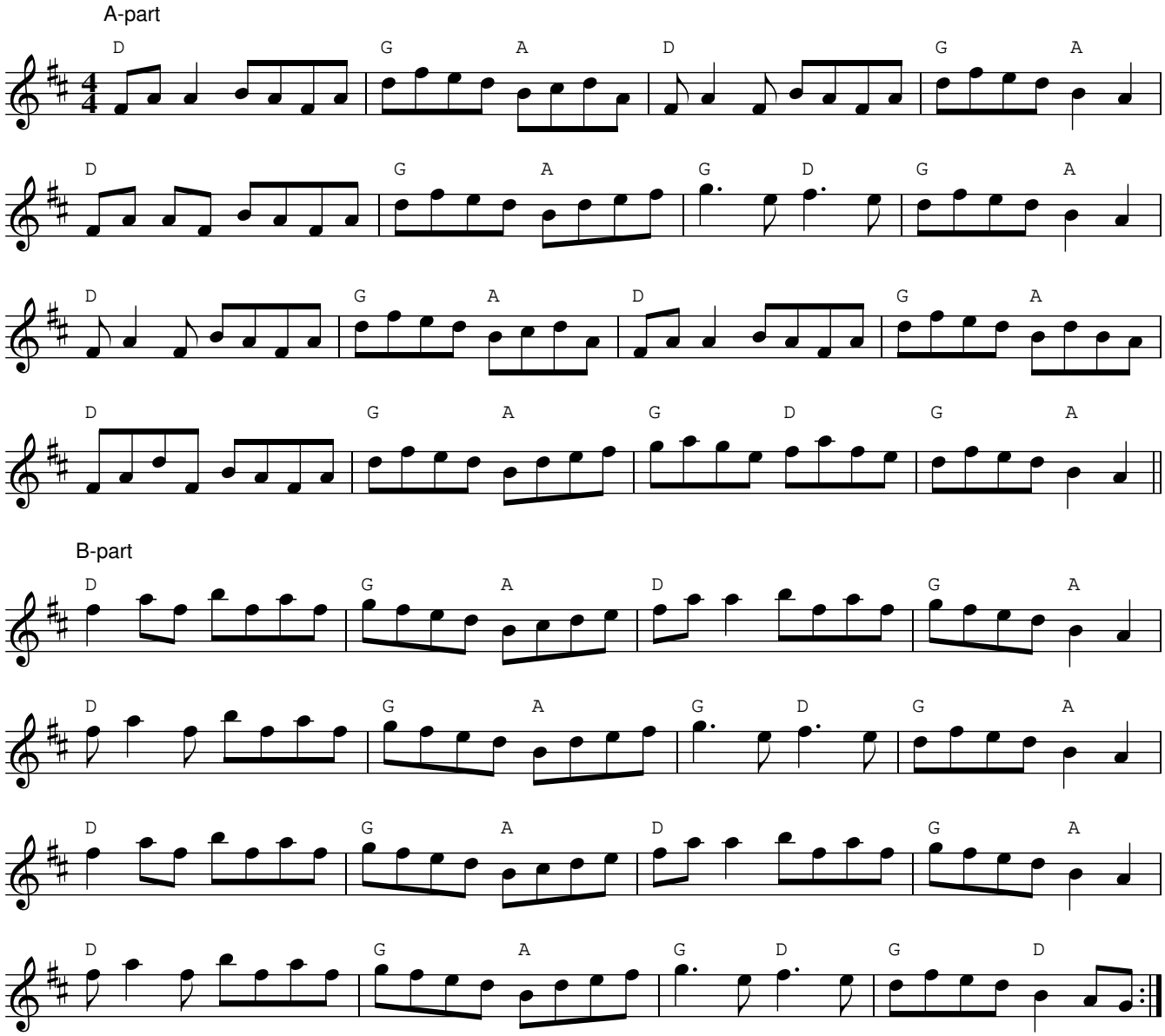
Ferry Reel



Source: See, e.g. Aly Bain and Tom Anderson, _The Silver Bow: The Fiddle Music of Shetland_ (2016).
Notes: Some Shetland reels. I was originally going to list these separately, but they seem often to be grouped in a set.

The Silver Spear

Trad.
reel



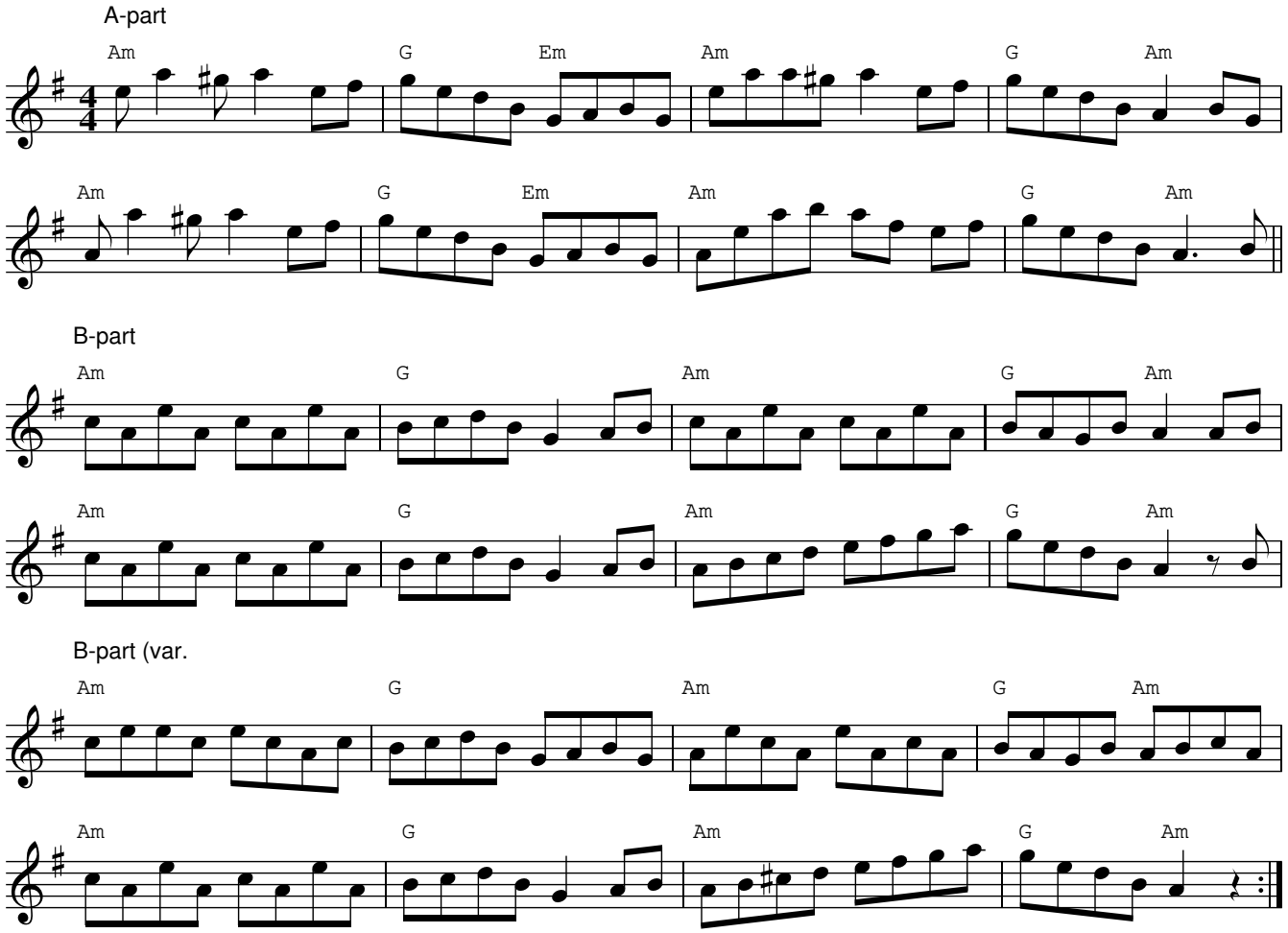
A-/B-parts ==
D G/A D · G/A
D G/A G/D G/A

Source: Adapted from versions at https://thesession.org/tunes/182
Notes: A fun tune I was shown in Durham! Popularly paired with Maid Behind the Bar.

Sleep Soond i da Moarnin’

Sleep Sound in the Morning

Trad.
reel



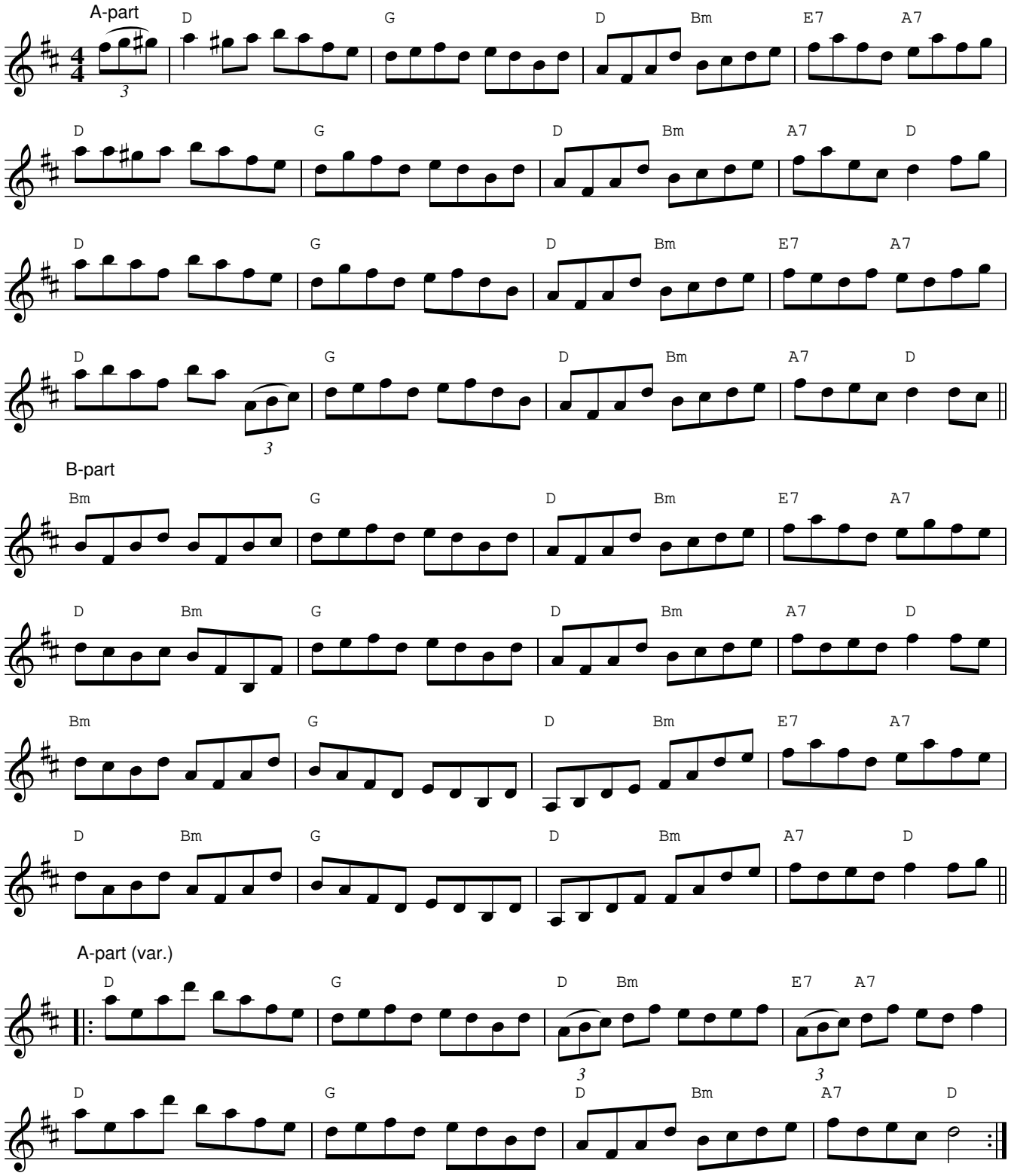

```
A-part ======== | B-part =====
Am G/Em Am G/Am | Am G Am G/Am
Am G/Em Am G/Am | Am G Am G/Am
```

Source: Maggie Sansone, _Mist and Stone_ (1990).

Notes: Note on the B-part variant: I don’t know why, but I always want to play the last C of the rising run as a C#. I know it’s out of the key, but I think it sounds awesome.

Smith's Reel

Trad.
reel



Chords: D G D A | D G A/AD :| Bm G D A | Bm G A A/D

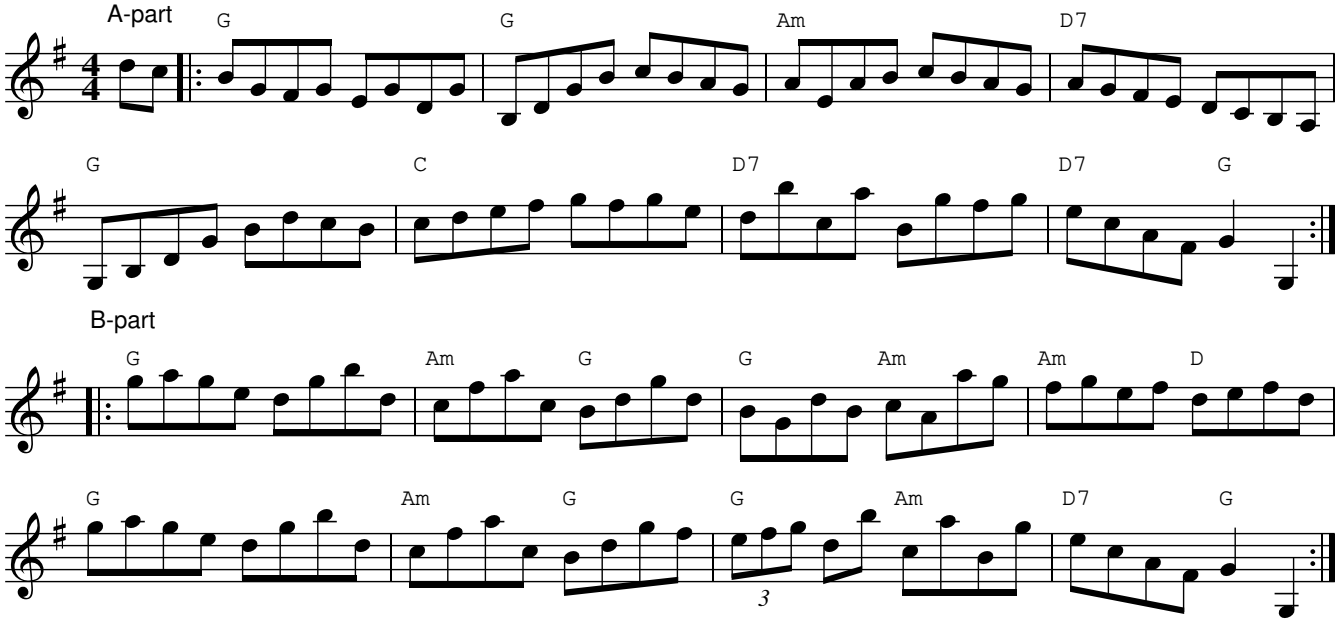
Alt.: D G D/Bm E7/A7 | D G D/Bm A7/D :| D/Bm G D/Bm E7/A7 | D/Bm G D/Bm A7/D :|

Source: Cameron Cross and Joey McKensie

Notes: I've seen some versions where the first chord in the A-part is Bm. I want to like it, but it sounds a little off.

The Stage Hornpipe

James Hill
hornpipe

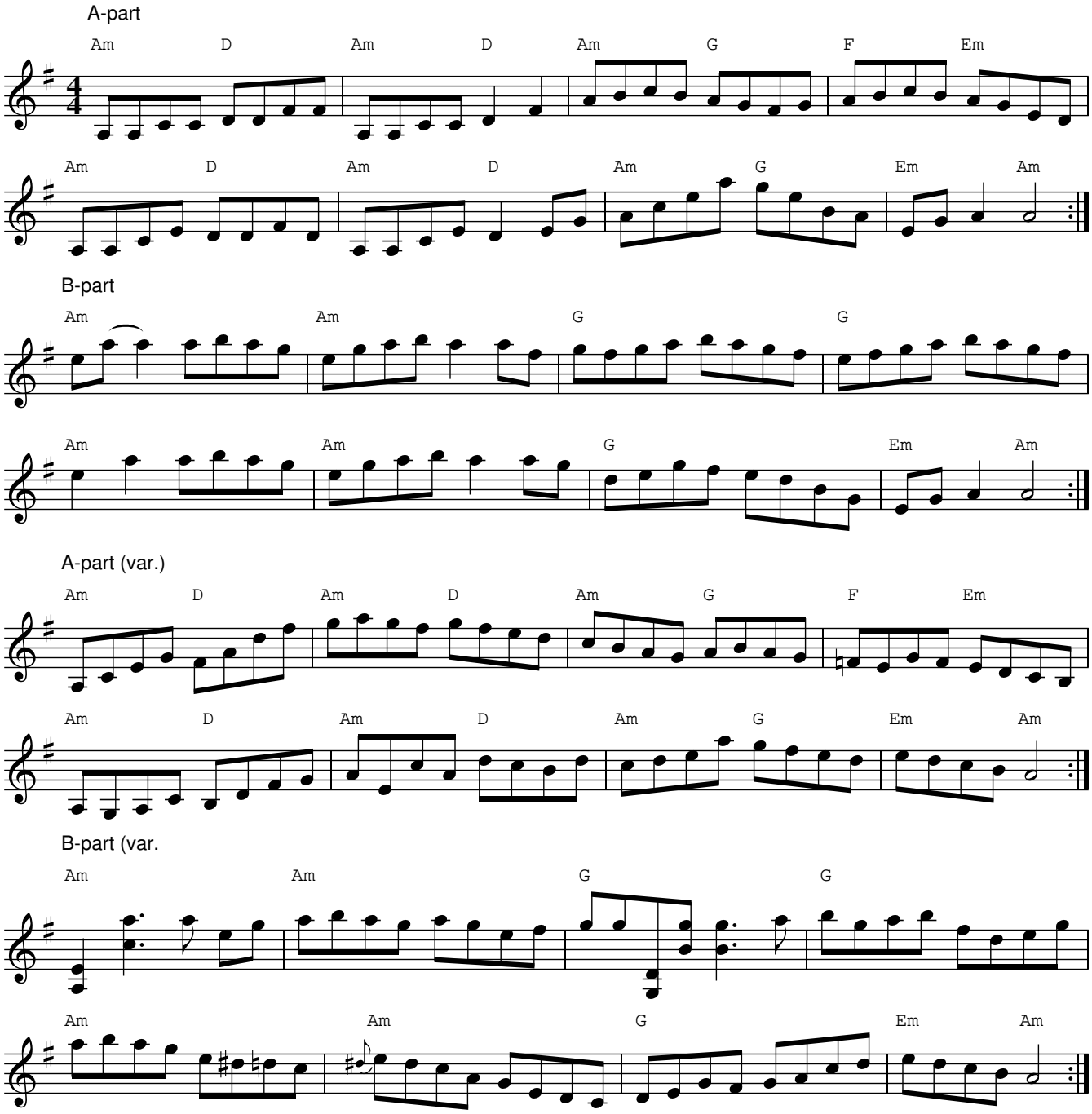


Chords: G G Am D7 | G C D7 D7/G :| G Am/G G/Am Am/D7 | G Am/G G/Am D7/G :|

Source: Adapted from https://thesession.org/tunes/1249

The Twenty-Eighth of January

Trad.
reel



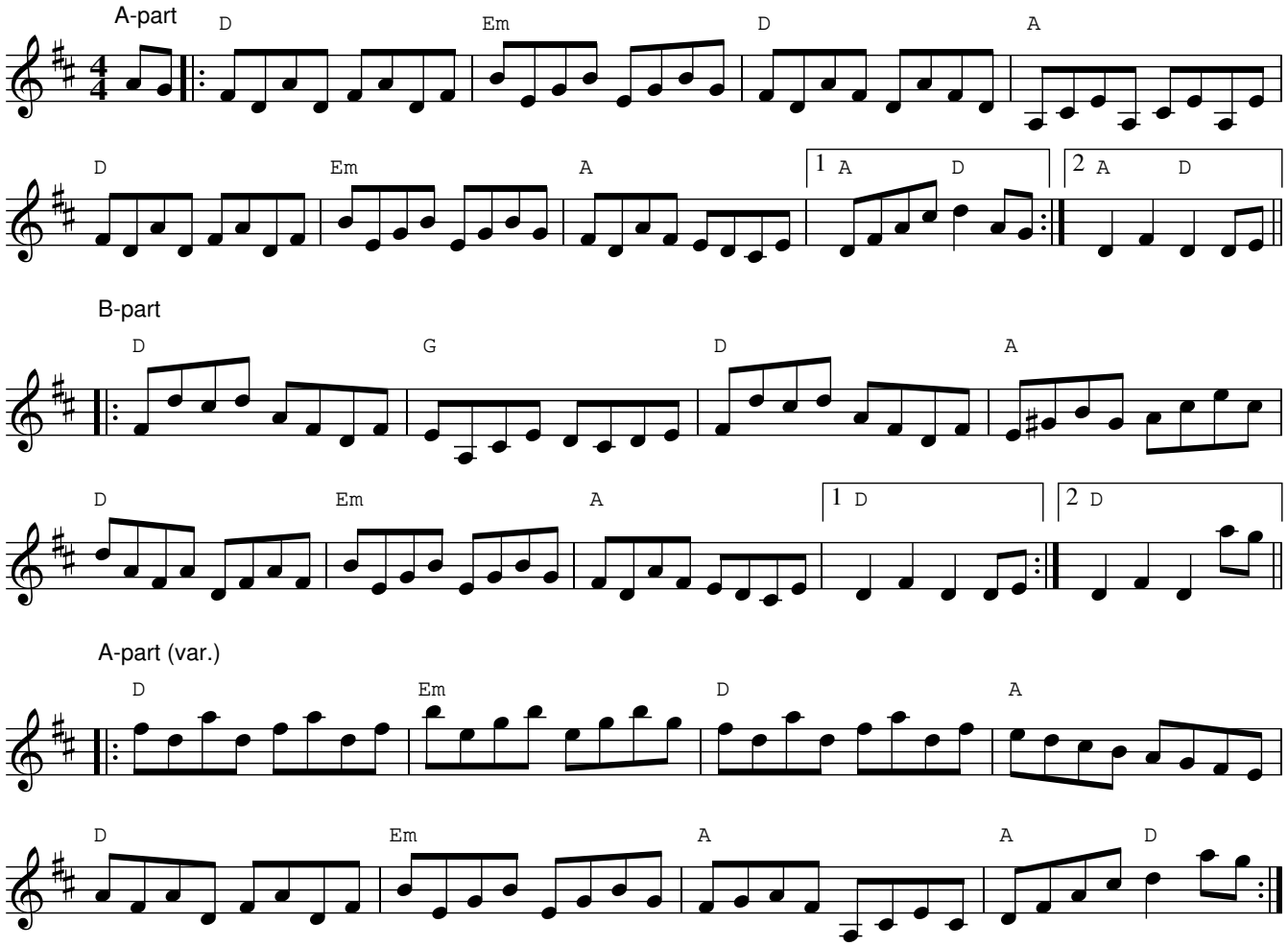

```
A-part ============= | B-part =============
Am/D Am/D Am/G F/Em ·| Am/D Am/D Am/G Em/Am
Am · Am · Gm · Em/Am | Am · Am · G ·· G ···
```

Source: _KY Contra Tunes_ and thesession.org/tunes/15717 for the base

Notes: Now this is an interesting number! The B-part follows a pretty standard I/VIIb progression found in many Celtic tunes, but the A-part uses the "Dorian vamp," pretty unusual in fiddle tunes but a staple in classic rock. For that reason, I think it's perhaps a more "jammy" tune than a melodic one; and one version I looked at had a G-F-Em-Am windup that gave it a little more of a bluesy punch. The top 4 bars are the tune in its base form, and the bottom 4 bars illustrate how I imagine the tune in a jam setting.

Westmoreland's Hornpipe

Terry Morris
hornpipe

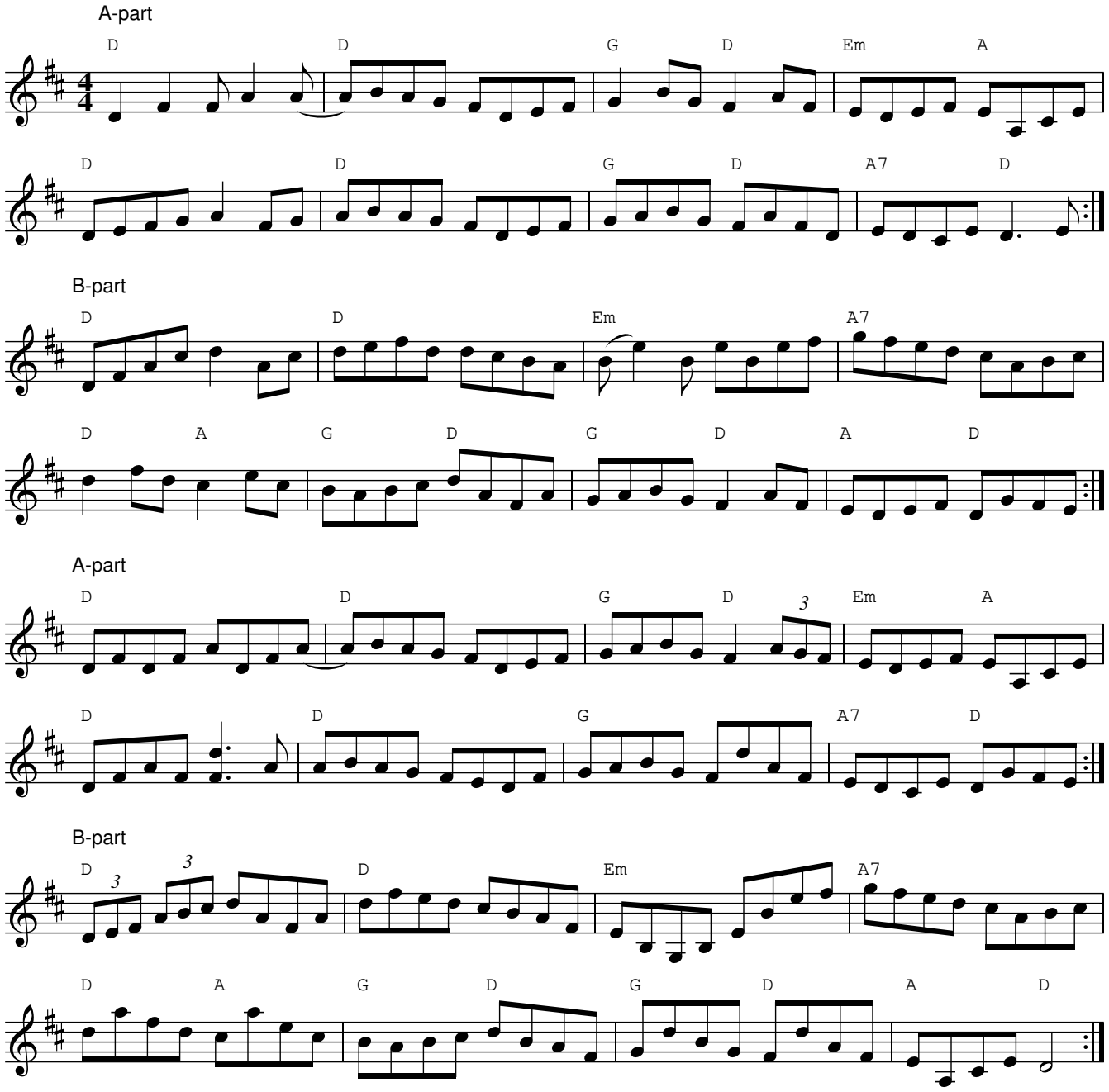


Chords: D Em D A | D Em A A/D :| D G D A | D Em A D :|

Source: Terry Morris, _Touch of Texas_ (1976)

Whiskey Before Breakfast

Trad.
reel



Chords: D D G/D Em/A | D D G/D A7/D :| D D Em A7 | D/A G/D G/D A/D :|

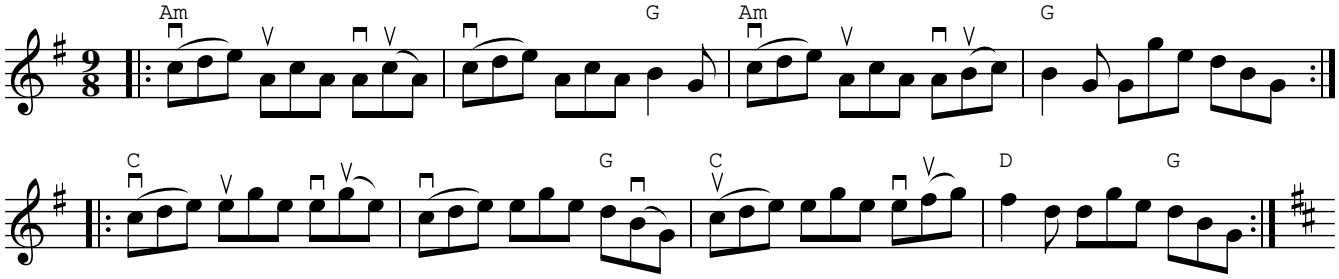
Source: Cam Cross

Notes: Classic, beautiful tune. Rough transcription of how I like to play it.

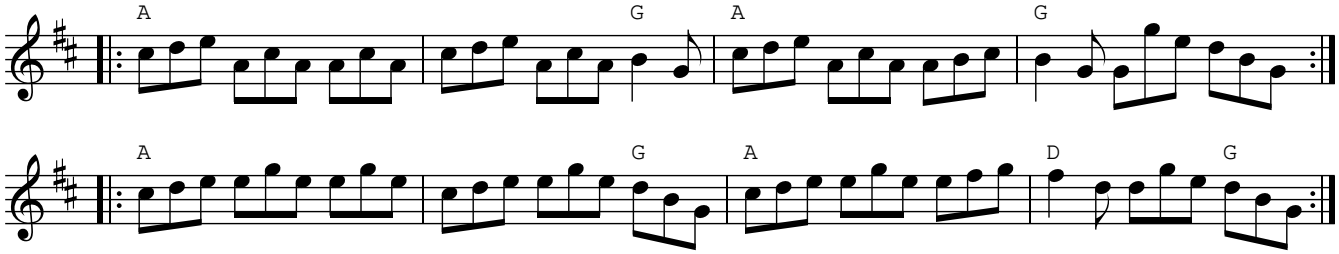
Brose and Butter + Cuzle Together

BB a.k.a. The Peacock Followed The Hen

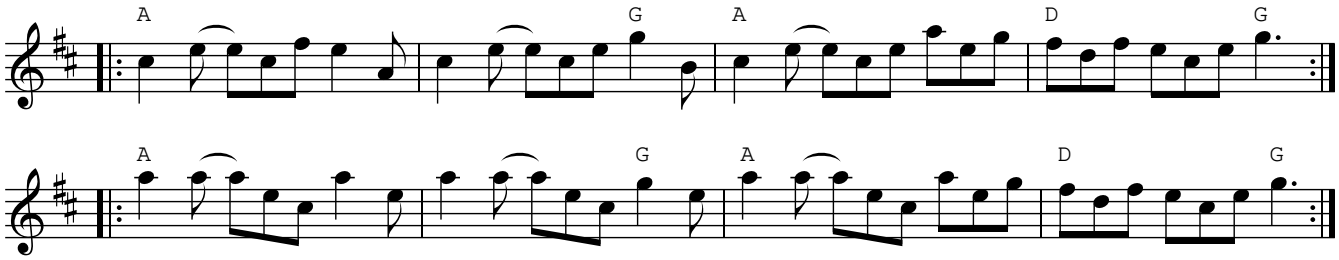
Trad.
slipjig



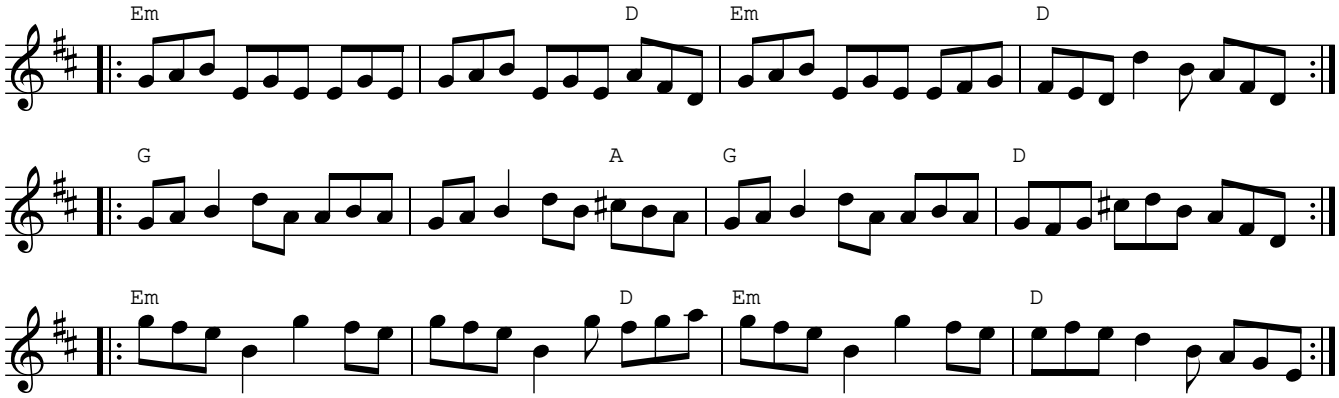
Bonnie's variation



Cuzle Together



Edor version by Fraser and Haas

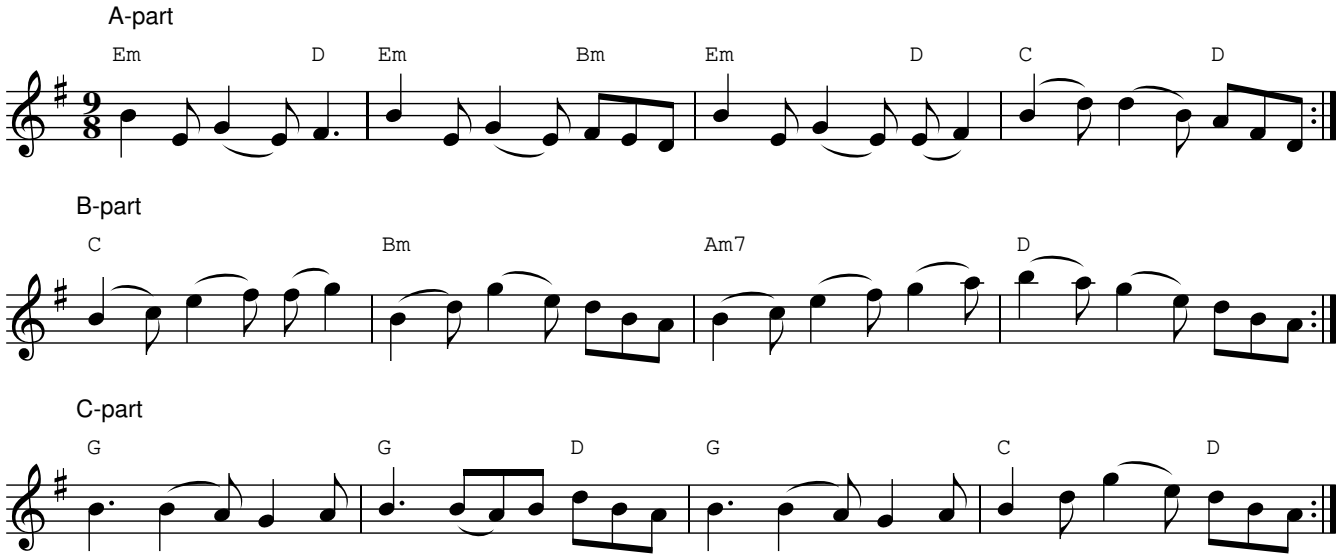


Source: Bonnie Rideout, _Scottish Fire_ (2000); A. Fraser and N. Haas, _Fire & Grace_ (2004).

Notes: Bonnie plays this on the viola and it sounds awesome. I've transposed it up a fifth to work on the fiddle. Another interesting thing is that she switches between A dorian (with a C natural) - which seems to be the standard - and mixolydian (C sharp). She combines B&B with Cuzle Together, another slipjig also in Amix (as well as Elsie Marly). This is supplemented with a version in Edor by Fraser and Haas, with a nice B-part.

The Butterfly

Tommy Potts
slipjig



A-part: Em/D Em/Bm Em/D C/D :|

B-part: C ·· Bm ·· Am · D · :|

C-part: G ·· G/D · G ·· C/D :| (The Gs can be substituted for Ems if preferred)

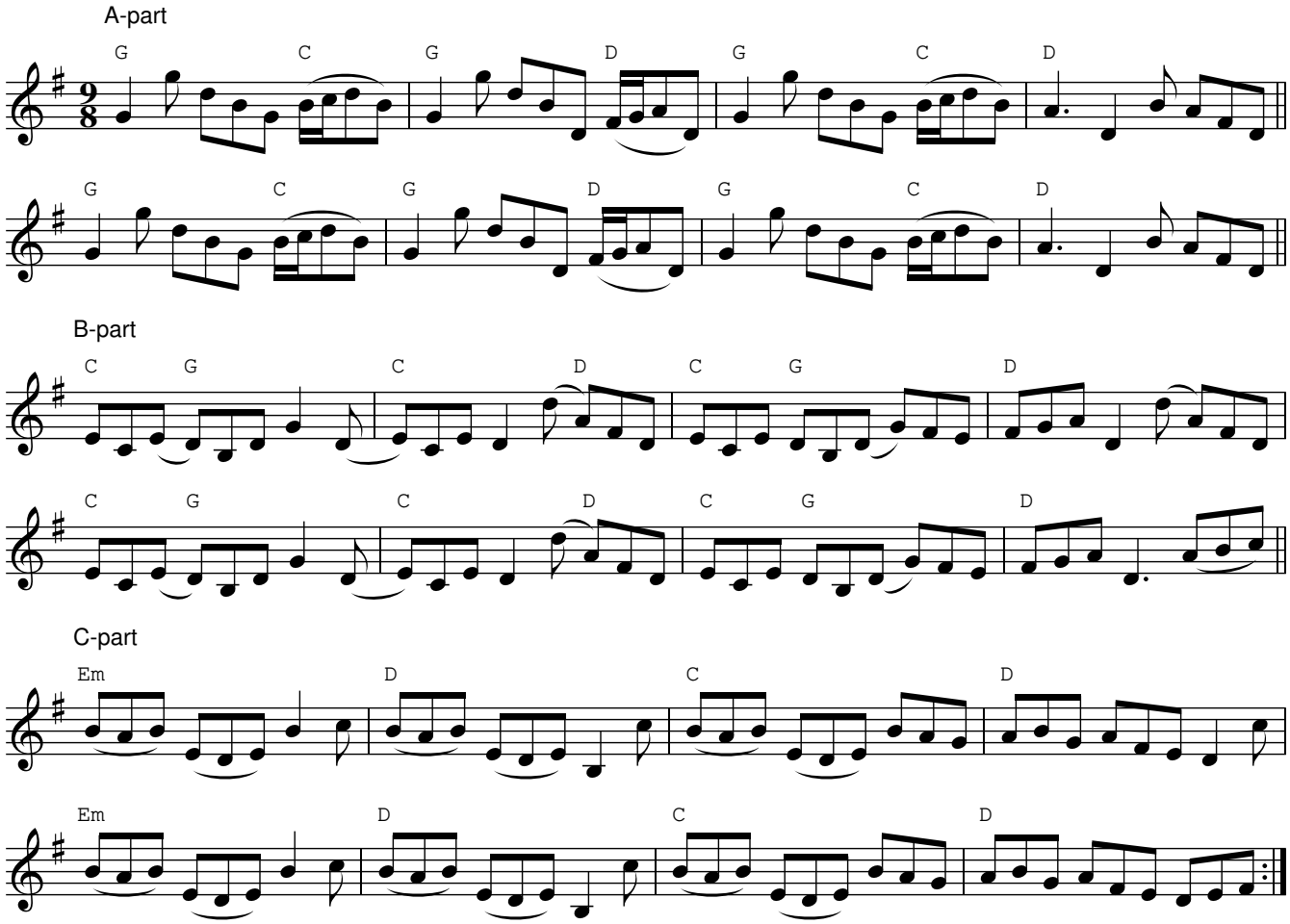
Source: The Good Tune

Notes: I've modified the bowing to something that makes more sense to me. But of course this is just a model to be played with.

The Yorkshire Trip

a.k.a. Danish Slipjig

Trad.
slipjig

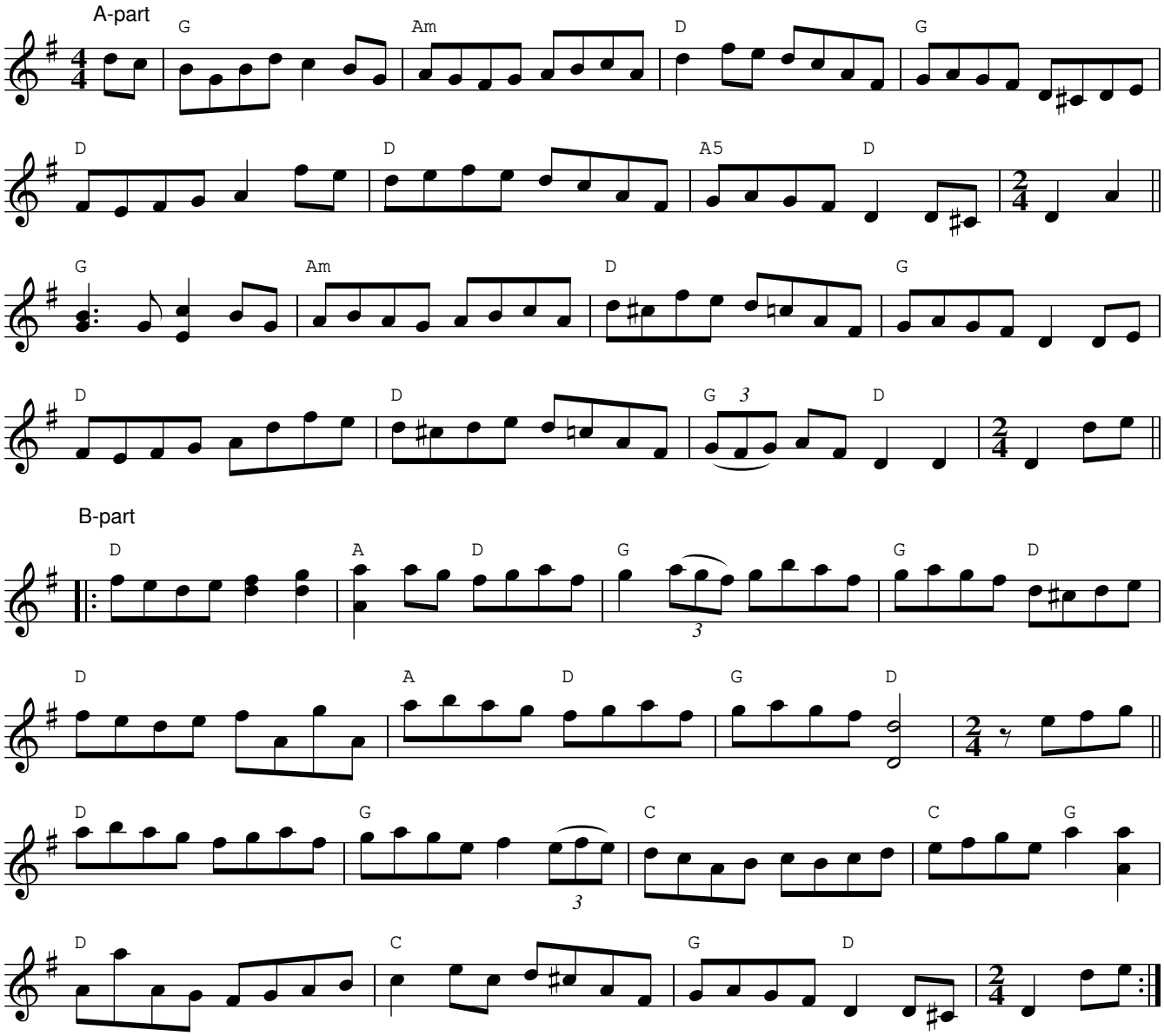


A-part: G/G/C G/G/D G/G/C D :|
B-part: C/G/G C/D/D C/G/G D :|
C-part: Em ·· D ··· C ··· D :|

Source: William Vickers' Collection of Dance Tunes (1770); The Good Tune
Notes: A very nice slipjig; the sixteenth notes in the first part give it a distinctive touch.

The Blackbird (Set Dance)

Trad.
set dance



Source: Bobby Gardiner, _Memories of Claire_ (1996) with my own variations.

Notes: Lovely tune! Unusually (as far as I know), each part ends with an extra two beats.
Has a strong melodic sympathy with the Blackbird Hornpipe. D mixolydian.
Best played slow and syncopated (see Bobby Gardiner's version). Repeats are intentional.
Chords still tentative.